



ATM & JEWELLERY?

WHAT'S THE CONNECTION?
FIND OUT ON 21ST AUGUST.

The advertisement features a man with a beard and white shirt, smiling and holding several gold coins and question marks in his hands. A large gold coin with the letters 'ATM' is prominently displayed in the foreground. The background is red with various gold coins and question marks floating around. The text 'ATM & JEWELLERY?' is written in large, bold, yellow letters, and 'WHAT'S THE CONNECTION? FIND OUT ON 21ST AUGUST.' is written in white letters below it.

INBRIEF



Book by Southern Railway's General Manager launched

Director of IIT Madras V. Kamakoti released the book *Beyond the Ivy League: Traits, Skills and Wisdom That Make Great Leaders* at a function held in Chennai on Thursday. The book was written by R.N. Singh, General Manager of Southern Railway, and published by Simon & Schuster. Lauding the book for its practical approach, Mr. Kamakoti said the principles discussed in it would be relevant not only to administrators and professionals, but also to students and future leaders navigating an increasingly dynamic world. Mr. Singh is set to retire from his post this month.

Text & Context and Health

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (July 24, Friday), the following articles are available:

■ How should cities reclaim footpaths? [newsth.live/streetvendorsact](#)

■ Building resilience to protect elderly from climate stressors [newsth.live/elderlyclimate](#)

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Protests demanding NEET ban gather momentum across city

In support of Delhi protests, CJP and AISA hold demonstrations at CPI State headquarters; Neelam Students Movement at Rajarathinam Stadium. Educationist Prince Gajendra Babu, singer Arivu, actor Andrea Jeremiah, among others, participate

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Opposition to the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) continues to gain momentum as various student groups and activists stage protests across the city, seeking the abolition of the entrance examination and the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

On Thursday, protests were held by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-Tamil Nadu and the All India Students' Federation (AISA) at the CPI State headquarters, and by the Neelam Students Movement led by director Pa. Ranjith at Rajarathinam Stadium.

These were also a mark of solidarity with the protests in Delhi, demanding educational reforms and supporting activist Sonam Wangchuk, who is on a hunger strike.

Tamil Nadu has been voicing its opposition to NEET since 2017, and has also passed a Bill in the Le-



Firm stand: Filmmaker Pa. Ranjith-led Neelam Students Movement staging a protest at Rajarathinam Stadium on Thursday, demanding educational reforms and the abolition of NEET. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

gislative Assembly to exempt the State from the examination.

Participating in the protest, actor Revathi said, "The visuals of the attack on students and children in Delhi on July 20 are unbearable. A united India is seen and so many people are trying to dismantle it." Expressing solidarity,

filmmaker Vetrimaaran said consistent efforts were required to scrap the examination and he promised to stand by the movement till the end. "The Centre's biggest motive seems to be to take away our medical education and knowledge so that we fold our hands to them. We must continue to prot-



There is an accusation that Gen Z don't have political understanding. We must focus on how to politicise them

PA. RANJITH
Director

est to ban NEET," he said.

Mr. Ranjith said: "There is an accusation that Gen Z don't have political understanding. We must focus on how to politicise them. The lack of politicisation is why we lost people due to NEET in the last 10 years."

'Protest is for India'

Pointing out that the BJP was afraid of Babasaheb Ambedkar, he said the protest in Delhi was not just for the CJP's leader. "The protest is for India. The fact that it begins with Jai Bhim gives people a lot of faith. It needs to spread across India," he said.

Educationist Prince Gajendra Babu, singer Arivu, actor Andrea Jeremiah,

and other prominent film personalities also participated in the protest.

Meanwhile, the police detained members of the Democratic Youth Federation of India and the Students' Federation of India during their protest at Guindy.

Over 500 students of New College in Royapettah also protested outside their college, condemning the police brutality against students in Delhi.

'Silent on Dalit issues'

Pointing out that no Dalit Minister in Chief Minister Vijay's Cabinet has spoken out on Dalit issues, Mr. Ranjith said: "There are eight Dalit Ministers in the Cabinet, but apart from Social Justice Minister Vanni Arasu, nobody has spoken out on Dalit issues in the past two months. Even School Education Minister Rajmohan, who we did not even know was a Dalit until he contested in Egmore. It is good that a Dalit has been made a Minister. but it has not brought change."

IIT-M students rally in support of Delhi protests, 'ordered' to remove posts on social media

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

IIT-Madras students organised a spontaneous gathering in support of the student protests in New Delhi's Jantar Mantar on Wednesday, even as the institute's management asked them to take down posts that supported the protests earlier in the week.

A student of IIT-Madras, on condition of anonymity, said Chintabar – a registered, independent students' body in IIT-Madras – had sought permission to conduct an event on Monday evening, in support of the students' protests at Jantar Mantar and the fast undertaken by Sonam Wangchuk.

The student alleged that the Dean of Students called the student organisers and the faculty adviser, and threatened them of consequences if

they did not take down a call-for-action video that was put up on Chintabar's Instagram handle. The animated video showing Sonam Wangchuk on a fast has since been taken down, although it is still up on a few other social media handles.

However, the students took the help of other social media pages to call for another gathering on Wednesday. It was attended by a few hundred students, who gathered within a two-hour notice. Since the event did not have an organiser, the students brought their own materials and created posters.

The student said that they were trying to mobilise funds, materials, and medicines to be sent to New Delhi in aid of the students protesting there.

They added that the management was yet to respond to the spontaneous gathering.

Two more held in ₹100-crore private schools approval scam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Central Crime Branch on Thursday arrested two more persons in connection with an alleged scam in which private schools across

the State were cheated of ₹100 crore on the promise of government approvals.

The accused were identified as Arokiyaraj, alias Raja, 39, of Madurai, and Suresh, 49, of Tiruchi.

The police said the duo,

who are relatives of the prime accused, B.T. Arasakumar, allegedly assisted him in collecting money from the private school managements, despite having no connection with the schools.

The case was registered

based on a complaint by T.C. Elangovan, Secretary of the Federation of Associations of Private Schools in Tamil Nadu. The complainant had alleged that Arasakumar and his associates had collected ₹100 crore from the private

school managements, promising them permanent recognition, school upgradation, DTCP and CMDA approvals, and other statutory clearances, but failed to secure the promised approvals or return their money.

TNCSC staff arrested for PDS rice smuggling

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Civil Supplies-CID has arrested two employees of the Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation (TNCSC) and a lorry driver for allegedly diverting and smuggling Public Distribution System (PDS) rice meant for ration cardholders.

Acting on a tip-off, Civil Supplies-CID officials intercepted a lorry near Perambur on Wednesday, and found around 300 bags of PDS rice, weighing about 79 quintals, in the vehicle. The bags of rice and the lorry were seized.

The investigation revealed that the rice had allegedly been diverted with the involvement of TNCSC staff.

The arrested persons were identified as TNCSC employees Mukathu Ali and Shiyam Murthi, and lorry driver Senthil Murugan.

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Brahma Gana Sabha
at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall, Alwarpet

NALLI AADI NAATYA VIZHA
Today - July 24 - 5.45 pm : ADITI RAMAN (Dis of Dr Gayathri Chandrashekar): 7.15pm: SANJANA CHANDRASEKARAN (Dis of Dr Gayathri Chandrashekar) : On 26.07.26 5.45 pm ARUNIMA SUNILRAJ, 7.15pm SHRADHA MURALI DHARAN. ALL ARE WELCOME.

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NADA SUDHA (Regd) at Sri Ganapathy Sachchidananda Ashram Hall, Baby Nagar, Velachery. Ph: 9176309996/9884949597
Nallis Aadi Natya Vizha (24.7.26 to 26.7.26)
Today July 24th - 5 pm Inauguration by Sri Nalli Kuppuswami Chetti (Industrialist and Philanthropist)
5.30 pm Varsha Viswanathan -Disciple of Kum Lakshmi Krishnan , Temple of Fine Arts, Singapore
6.45pm Irshika N Krishnamurthy -Disciple of Smt. Supriya Komandur, Amruthavashini Foundation for Arts -All are Welcome

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Naada Inbam, 24992672.
Today 6.15pm VSP Gayatri Sivani - Violin Solo, B Sivaraman, KV Gopalakrishnan. Concert dedicated to Smt Andal & Sri V Ananthanarayanan. Ragasudha Hall.

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JAGATHGURU
by G.V.Chandramohan

Saturday 25th July 2026, 6:45 p.m.
@ Narada Gana Sabha Hall, Alwarpet
Sunday, 26th July 2026, 6:45 p.m.
@ Mylapore Fine Arts Club

All are Welcome

MISCELLANEOUS

The Madras Sanskrit College
TODAY 6.30 PM Mahakavi Sri Nilakanta Dikshithar Foundation Endowment Lecture, Tamil Upanyasam on VAIRAGYA SATAKAM & SHANTI VILASAM Book Release by Dr. R. Ramachandran (Vidvat Parishad Pramukh, Samskrita Bharati) Chief Guest address Prof. V. Kamakoti, Director, IIT Madras, at Sanskrit College Premises, Mylapore, Chennai. All are welcome.

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PERSONAL	EDUCATIONAL	PUBLIC NOTICE
CHANGE OF NAME MY SON, Sidhesh.M, born on 10th September 2019/District of Birth Krishnaginji Residing at No.167, Kommampattu, Govindapuram, Uthangarai, Krishnaginji-635307, Shall henceforth be known as Jashvanth.M.The same has been published in Gazette on 06.07.2022.Pg No.984.Manikandan.M(Father)	VACANCIES WANTED PGT Home-Tutor Full-Time IIT-JEE Maths, Phy, Chem. 98410 13527 WANTED PGT Decent Salary Commerce, Physics, Mathematics,English, Computer Science (Near Pallavaram) for Cbse/Matricschools. Apply to sgscrcruitment@gmail.com	PUBLIC NOTICE Our Client proposes to develop the property being Ground, House and Premises bearing New Door No.9 and Old Door No.6, Binny Road, Poes Garden (earlier Door No.6, 4th Street, Kasturi Ranga Road, Chennai-600 086, comprised in R.S.No. 1570/12 (land measuring 1 Ground and 1678 Sq.ft.), R.S.No.1571/4 (land measuring 108 Sq.ft.) and R.S.No. 1571/16 (land measuring 198 Sq.ft.), Block No.32, situated in Mylapore Division (Village) (now Mylapore (Part 1) Town), Mylapore Taluk, Chennai District, land measuring a total extent of 1 Ground and 1984 Sq.ft. (4384 Sq.ft.) or thereabouts (hereinafter referred to as "the Said Property") belonging to Mrs. Tara Balakrishnan, wife of Dr. A. Balakrishnan (hereinafter referred to as the "Owner"). The Owner represents that the Original Settlement Deed dated 01.02.1984 executed by her father, Mr. S. Govindarajan in her favour and registered as Document No.70 of 1984 in the Office of the District Registrar of Madras Central, in respect of the Said Property, was misplaced by the Owner and the same is not traceable. The Owner represents that the Owner is the absolute owner of the Said Property and except the Owner no one has any right, title, interest, demand or claim of whatsoever nature over the same, that the Said Property is free from all encumbrances, mortgages, litigations, court/tribunal/ debt/ revenue proceedings, awards, claims, acquisition and requisition proceedings and that the Owner is in absolute possession and sole enjoyment of the same as its absolute owner. If anybody is in possession of the aforesaid original Settlement Deed or having any right, title, interest, lien, charge, demand or claim of whatsoever nature, upon or to the Said Property or any portion thereof, by way of easement or agreements, arrangements, lease, trust, inheritance, gift, partitions, bequests, possession, mortgage, exchange, will or under any deed/instrument or otherwise, he/she is requested to hand over the aforesaid document to the undersigned or bring to the notice of the undersigned his/her their interest or claim or demand along with supporting documentary evidence by Speed Post Acknowledgement Due or in person within 21 days from the date of this publication, failing which it will be presumed that there is no claim, right, title, interest, charge or encumbrance over the Said Property by any person and our Client will proceed with the development of the Said Property without any risk and any subsequent claim or objection shall be deemed to have been waived. N. SRINIVASAN, B.A., LL.B., B.A. BALACHANDHAR, M.Com, LL.B. Advocates Flat No.5, Raaga Apartments Door Nos.66 & 68, Venkatakrishna Road Mandaveli, Chennai - 600 028 Cell: 98840 20722

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To the best of our knowledge and belief, the Film is free from any encumbrances, claims or demands, whatsoever. However, should any person(s) have claim against, or, in respect of the Film, whether by way of any sale, lease, assignment, license, pledge, gift, mortgage, charge, sale, litigation, and/or transfer of any kind whatsoever or otherwise, such person(s) are hereby requested to make the same known in writing along with documentary proof/evidence (certified true copies) of the aforesaid claim to the undersigned at the address given below, within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication hereof, failing which the transaction will be completed without reference to such claims and the claims, if any, will be deemed to have been waived. Claims without any documentary proof and/or any claims received after the expiry of the stipulated 7 (seven) days shall not be entertained.

SCHEDULE

Title of the Film: **MECHANIC ROCKY**
Language(s): Tamil (Dubbed)
Star Cast: Vishwak Sen, Meenakshi Chaudhary and others
Director: Mr. Ravi Teja Mullapudi
Effective Date: 23rd July 2026
End Date: Perpetual
Territory: Entire World (Exclusive for India territories and non-exclusive for rest of the world)
Runs: Unlimited
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Dated : 24th July 2026
Place : Chennai 1206-1208, 12th Floor, Elite Business Park, In the lane of Shapath Hexa rights, Next to Prapatti Bhavan, Near Kargill Petrol Pump, Sola, Ahmedabad, Gujarat- 380 060.

Nanavati & Co Advocates Sol-
1206-1208, 12th Floor, Elite Business Park, In the lane of Shapath Hexa rights, Next to Prapatti Bhavan, Near Kargill Petrol Pump, Sola, Ahmedabad, Gujarat- 380 060.

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RENTAL

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AMBATTUR Commercial Building Nr Stedford hospital 2300Sft Gr flr and 1st flr each Rs 40psft negt. Suit for warehouse and industry. 9025170694	RESIDENTIAL
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CHETPET	MUGALIVAKKAM
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World Bank to fund civic infrastructure projects for creating circular economy

The funding will help in setting up world class facilities for health infrastructure; this partnership leverages World Bank expertise to drive sustainable urban development, says GCC Commissioner

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

The World Bank will fund civic infrastructure projects of the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) to facilitate transition to a circular economy, develop world class facilities for health infrastructure, improve flood resilience and create electric vehicle charging infrastructure.

On Thursday, GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran met with a high-level delegation from the World Bank Group to discuss the implementation of key urban, environmental and infrastructure projects in the city with World Bank financial assistance.

The World Bank delegation included Ommid Saberi (Principal Industry Specialist), Nguyen Nhan (Global Operations Lead), and Autif Mohammed Sayed (Green Building Expert).

Talking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Sameeran said: "We discussed with the World Bank team integrated flood management in Chennai and flood resilience of the Corporation's assets, public private partnership opportunities like EV



Long-term vision: Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran at a meeting with a high-level delegation from the World Bank Group on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

charging stations across the city, world class infrastructure for GCC health centres and hospitals and schools, building rooftop solar and cooling."

In the meeting, discussions centred around several key initiatives aimed at transforming Chennai Corporation infrastructure through World Bank financial assistance and technical support. A major focus was placed on enhancing climate resilience by developing robust strategies for integrated flood and rescue management, as well as implementing urban heat mitigation measures such as cool-roof solutions to reduce the urban heat is-

land effect across Corporation buildings.

To advance the city's clean energy and sustainable mobility goals, the proposal includes setting up a widespread network of Electric Vehicle (EV) charging stations at strategic locations and installing rooftop solar panels on administrative complexes and schools, officials said.

Additionally, the collaboration aims to elevate the Corporation's medical facilities to global standards, equipping the public health system with advanced technical support for long-term readiness. Beyond environmental and public health improve-

ments, the meeting addressed economic sustainability by exploring strategies for asset monetisation, specifically optimising the use of Corporation owned lands and facilities to boost revenue generation.

The teams also discussed increasing revenue of the civic body; technical and viability gap funding for GCC projects and technical assistance for the circular economy. "Overall, this partnership leverages World Bank expertise to drive sustainable urban development and environmental conservation throughout the city," Mr. Sameeran said.

3 held for possession of painkiller tablets

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The city police arrested three persons, including a woman and her son, for possessing a large quantity of painkiller tablets intended for illegal sale.

The police noticed four persons moving suspiciously in Otteri on Wednesday morning. One of the suspects managed to

escape. The police found 2,400 Nitrazepam 10 mg tablets concealed in their bag. The police registered a case at Secretariat Colony Police Station, and seized the tablets.

The arrested were identified as Akash, 26, of Otteri, his mother Pushpa, 42, and Raji, 19, of Perambur Barracks Road. Efforts are on to trace and arrest the fourth accused.

best of the world

Public healthcare steps in as injuries at work expose insurance gap among migrant workers

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

Akash Kumar lay quietly on a hospital bed, his world turned upside down by a workplace accident involving a steel-cutting machine that left him with a severe limb-threatening injury behind his left knee. With no family by his side, the 19-year-old from Bihar struggled to understand the flurry of conversations around him, held back by a language barrier in an unfamiliar place.

Beyond the severity of his injury, his situation has brought into focus a less visible challenge faced by many migrant workers - the lack of adequate financial protection. For many migrant workers like him, the State's public healthcare system has often become their only hope. At



Much-needed care: A migrant worker being treated at SMCH after suffering an industrial accident. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

the Department of Vascular Surgery, Government Stanley Medical College Hospital (SMCH), at least four to five migrant workers involved in workplace accidents are treated for major vascular trauma every month.

These include injuries sustained from fall from heights, machinery-related incidents in glass and tile manufacturing units, and

accidents involving agricultural equipment. "In Akash's case, the injury completely cut through the main blood artery behind the knee, nearby vein and nerves, making it a life and limb threatening injury. Losing a limb at 19 will devastate his life and livelihood. We performed a bypass procedure for major blood vessels in his left leg. Rehabilitation will take a longer period," K. Elan-cheralathan, professor and head, Department of Vascular Surgery, SMCH, said.

The beds next to Akash told similar stories. Two other migrant workers - Babu Sheik, 24, from West Bengal and Ragunath, 31, from Bihar - are being treated for severe vascular injuries.

"For many, the journey to definitive repair is a race against time. To survive,

they must withstand hours of a complex bypass procedure, simultaneous orthopaedic bone stabilisation and aggressive resuscitation by the emergency anaesthesia team. Managing these complex injuries often requires six to eight hours of operating theatre time. It requires an immediate minimum of four units of blood, transfused without delay, regardless of whether the patient has donors available. These patients often have no insurance or proper attendants, and face language barriers and unexpected complications. We ensure that they receive the best care," he added.

SMCH dean A. Aravind said the hospital routinely treats migrant workers, with Plastic Surgery and Orthopaedics departments managing many cases.

Timings CHENNAI

FRIDAY, JUL. 24

RISE 05:53 SET 18:38

RISE 14:30 SET 01:13

SATURDAY, JUL. 25

RISE 05:53 SET 18:38

RISE 15:23 SET 02:00

SUNDAY, JUL. 26

RISE 05:54 SET 18:38

RISE 16:15 SET 02:49

Chennai Weather max min

Tiruvallur 35 26

Chennai Airport 37 28

Chennai City 36 28

Chennai Airport Today

36°C The weather will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will also be uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershower.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow

37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Spell of rain and thundershower may occur. Night also will be uneasy.

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THE HINDU

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**TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED**

Unit-1: Kagithapuram – 639 136, Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu
Unit-2: Mondipatti – 621 306, Trichy District, Tamil Nadu

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS

Tender No	Description	Due Date
262713 002574	Procurement of Caustic Soda Lye for Unit-I and Unit-II	06.08.26
262713 002741	Procurement of Pigment Dyes (Violet & Blue) for Paper Machine # 1, 2 & 3 at Unit-I	06.08.26
262713 002740	Procurement of Heavy Duty LDPE Shrink Film 80/90 Microns of various sizes for Unit-I	06.08.26
262723 001708	Procurement of Latex 1 (Top Coat - Acrylic Binder) for Board Machine (CCK) of TNPL Unit - II	08.08.26
262723 001707	Procurement of Latex 2 (Pre Coat - SBR Binder) for Board Machine (CCK) of TNPL Unit - II	08.08.26

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites: www.tnpl.com / www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app

DIPR/2345/Tender/2026

STORES E-PROCUREMENT

E-procurement Tender Notice No. S/66/009/26-27 Dated: 20-07-2026 for Supply of Materials. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works.

Tender No. NJ265096
Closing/Opening date: 10-08-2026

Brief Description: Supply, testing and commissioning of waterless urinals in Three Phases Electric Passenger Locomotive as per RDSO Functional requirement specification no. RDSO/2023/EL/FRS/0034 (Rev-02) of September 2025 or latest, consignee: SSE/D/Siliguri Jn. NFR. Qty: 20 Nos.

Note: For full details of tender notice and tender documents, tenderer may log on to the website (www.ireps.gov.in). Prospective bidder who intend to participate in above tender are required to log on themselves with the above website and submit their offer electronically, if they are already registered with **IREPS**. In Case they are not registered with **IREPS**, they are advised to obtain class-III Digital Signature Certificate from the certifying agencies under Govt. of India IT Act 2000 and participate in the above tenders.

Dy. Chief Materials Manager, New Jalpaiguri
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
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**TAMIL NADU POWER FINANCE AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED**

Registered Office: 490/3-4, "Tufidco – Powerlin" Tower, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai – 600 035

Notification No. TNPF/HR/Recruitment/2026-03 Date: 24.07.2026

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

TNPFC invites application for the post of IT Personnels from the eligible candidates from **24.07.2026 to 19.08.2026** upto 5.00 pm.

Sl. No.	Name of the post	No of vacancy	Qualification & Experience	Consolidated pay	Mode of recruitment
1	IT Personnel Senior Level	01	Degree from recognized University-MCA/M.Sc. (IT/CS) B.E./B.Tech. (CSE/ECE/IT) with experience of 7-10 years in IT Sector	12 L.P.A to 15 L.P.A. (negotiable)	Contractual Basis for three years to five years
2	IT Personnel Junior Level	01	Degree from recognized University-MCA/M.Sc. (IT/CS) B.E./B.Tech. (CSE/ECE/IT) with experience of 3-5 years in IT Sector	7.5 L.P.A to 9 L.P.A. (negotiable)	Contractual Basis for three years to five years

Applications shall be submitted by Registered / Speed Post to the Registered Office. For the application form and detailed notification, visit <https://www.tnpowerfinance.com>

Sd/-
CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR
ADDITIONAL CHIEF SECRETARY TO GOVERNMENT
TAMIL NADU POWER FINANCE AND INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED, CHENNAI – 600 035.

DIPR/648/DISPLAY/2026

**Executive Engineer,
Soil Investigation Division,
Road Construction Department, Ranchi**

(e-Procurement Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.- 06/2026-27
4th Call
National Bidding

e-Tender Ref No – RCD/SID/APRAN/ 06 /2026-27 Date:-21.07.2026
Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division, RCD, Ranchi has been assigned the work of Consultancy Services for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report (D.P.R.) for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrapa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)

Proposals are hereby invited from eligible Consultants for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrapa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)

The Letter of Invitation (LOI) and Terms of Reference (ToR) including Request for Proposal (RFP) is available online on e-tender portal <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>. Refer instruction to bidder under e-tendering for submission of bid. The document can be downloaded from <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>. The consultants who download the RFP document from the website will be required to pay the non-refundable fee of Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand).

- As per the Departmental Letter no. - 4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit will be received in online mode only through e-procurement portal (<https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.
- The consulting firm must have significant experience in handling large-scale road infrastructure project. **Only those Bidders will participate who have experience in such type of projects in any state in India .**
- Road Construction Department, Government of Jharkhand (GOJ) invites proposal for the work mentioned in table through e-procurement System by National Bidding Process.

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy Services for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report (D.P.R) for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrapa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)
2	Tentative Length	12.00 km
3	Period of Completion of Work	60 Days
4	Cost of Tender documents& Earnest Money Deposit	Cost of Tender Document- Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand only) Earnest Money Deposit Rs- 20,000/- (Rupees Twenty Thousand only) As per the Departmental Letter no. - 4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Depo sit will be received in online mode only through e- procurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e -Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e - tendering (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	25.07.2026 At 10:30 AM
7	Availability of online tender/ Bid submission period	25.07.2026, 10:30 AM to 10.08.2026, 12:00 Noon
8	Place of Opening of Tender Paper	Chief Engineer (Communication), Road Construction Department, 1stFloor, Engineer Hostel No. -2, Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004
09	Last date of submission of Bids	10.08.2026 at 12:00 Noon
10	Date of opening of Bids	11.08.2026 at 12:30 PM
11	Bid validity	120 days
12	Designation and Contact no. of e-Procurement Officer	Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division, RCD, Ranchi Mob:- 9905660677 Email id - eeerdas@nic.in
13	PR No.-	374588 Road (26 -27) D, 376853 (26 -27)D, 380993 Road (26-27)D

Note:-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Soil Investigation Division,
Road Construction Department, Ranchi

PR 385661
Road(26-27)D

**THE HINDU**

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

**Centre For Railway Information Systems**
Chankayapuri, New Delhi-110021

Expression of Interest (Eoi)
Centre for Railway Information Systems (CRIS), an autonomous society under Ministry of Railways manages multiple Data Centres across Indian Railways to support mission-critical applications including passenger, freight service, infrastructure, human resource, finance, security related applications. Over the years, the scale of IT applications and data volumes has increased significantly, necessitating enhanced capacity, resilience, and modernization of CRIS Data Centre infrastructure. Consequently, CRIS is examining various hosting options including CRIS-owned, Bulk-Operate-Transfer/PPP, Colocation or hybrid model with managed services, etc. to formulate a comprehensive long-term Data Centre ecosystem. This Expression of Interest (Eoi) is invited to identify interested parties which can offer these solutions. Interested parties including Data Centre Operators, Project Management Consultants, Project Execution Agencies, etc. are requested to respond to email at: harisham@cris.org.in by **26.07.2026, 17:00 Hrs** with details as listed below:
1. Name of the Organization;
2. Details of Data Centres in Delhi-NCR area;
3. Contact Person;
4. Contact No.;
5. Email;
6. Details of experience in offering solutions to different organizations;
7. Any other relevant details;
8. Any queries.
A meeting in this regard is being organized at CRIS Conference Hall, 4th Floor, DMRC Building, Supreme Court Metro station, New Delhi on **30.07.2026 at 11:00 Hrs**. Interested parties may please attend.

**MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT & HIGHWAYS**
CHENNAI ENNORE PORT ROAD COMPANY LIMITED
(A Special purpose vehicle of National Highways Authority of India)
5th Floor, CMRL Building, Poonamallee High Road, Koyambedu, Chennai-600 107.
Telephones: 044-22251885 Email: chennai@nhai.org

PUBLIC NOTICE
Revision of user fee for the year 2026-2027 for Ennore - Manall Road Improvement Project connecting the Chennai and Ennore Ports with Inner Ring Road from Km 25/000 to Km 17/500, Thiruvottiyur - Ponneri - Panchett Road from Km. 4/500 to Km. 13/500, Manall Oil refinery Road Junction from Km. 0/000 to Km. 5/600 and Ennore Expressway from Km. 0/000 to Km. 7/538, Improved and maintained on a long term basis by Chennai Ennore Port Road Company Limited (CEPRCL) or any agency appointed / authorized by CEPRCL to Collect the user fee at the rates specified in the schedule appended to this notification for the period up to recovery of the project capital cost of 600 crores and after recovery of the project capital cost, the tolls levy shall be reduced to 40% of the rates.
The approved revised user free rates for the above mentioned section to be applicable w.e.f. 25.07.2026 to 31.03.2027.
User fee rates for Mathur Toll Plaza @ Km.22/200 EMRIP for a Total length of Km. 28.333.

The Schedule

Category of Vehicles	Fee for Single Journey (₹)	Fee for Return Journey within 24 Hrs. (₹)	Fee for Monthly Pass for 50 Single Journeys in a month (₹)	Fee for single Journey for the Commercial vehicle (excluding vehicle plying National Permit) Registered in the district where the Toll Plaza falls
Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	45.00	70.00	1575.00	25.00
Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	75.00	115.00	2545.00	40.00
Bus or Truck	160.00	240.00	5330.00	80.00
Upto Three -Axle Vehicles	175.00	260.00	5815.00	85.00
4-6 Axle Vehicles, Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Vehicles (MAV) (four to six Axles)	250.00	375.00	8360.00	125.00
Oversized Vehicles (seven or more Axles)	305.00	460.00	10175.00	155.00

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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of The President of India, the Divisional Railway Manager (Engg)/Ranchi, South Eastern Railway invites e-tenders for the following works.
Sl. No.; Notice No.; Name of work; Tendering Value; EMD Value;
(1); DRMEGNG RNC-60-2026; Supply, loading into Railway Wagons / Hoppers and Stacking of 87,950 Cum of 50 mm Gauge Machine - Crushed Hard Stone Track Ballast at BARLanga Depot, Including Unloading, dressing & boxing in Ranchi Division; ₹ 13,31,66,852.97; ₹ 26,63,300; **(2); DRMEGNG RNC-61-2026;** Supply and stacking of 83000 cum 50 mm gauge hard stone machine crushed hard stone track ballast at Ramgarh depot including loading into Railway Wagon/ Hoppers and unloading the same in Ranchi Division; ₹ 11,99,72,757.70; ₹ 23,99,500; **Tender Closing date & time:** 14.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs. (for Sl. No. 1 & 2); Tenderers can visit the website www.ireps.gov.in for online tendering.
(PR-512)

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग
E-mail: rdsd hazaribagh@gmail.com

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हजारीबाग

PR 385701 Rural Development(26-27)#D

**Government of India**
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)
Project Implementation Unit - Chennai-1
5th Floor, CMRL Building, Poonamallee High Road, Koyambedu, Chennai-600 107.
Telephone:044-22251884, E-mail: chennai@nhai.org



PUBLIC NOTICE
Revised User Fee (Toll) Rates at Nallur Toll Plaza Applicable from 25.7.2026
The approved user fee rate for Chennai – Tada Section of NH-5 from Km. 11/000 to Km. 54/400 are to be applicable w.e.f. 25.07.2026 to 31.03.2027. The user fee rate for Nallu Toll Plaza (Km.21/625 near Nallur Village, Thiruvallur District) in the State of Tamilnadu are as under:

Sl. No.	Category of vehicle	Fee at the base rate per Km per vehicle for one way trip (in Rupees)	Fee for single Journey (in Rupees)	Fee for Return Journey within a day (in Rupees)	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single trips journey in a month (in Rupees)	Fee for commercial vehicles registered within the district of Plaza
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	0.65	85	130	2835	45
2	Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	1.05	135	205	4585	70
3	Bus or Truck (Two Axles)	2.20	290	430	9600	145
4	Three -Axle commercial Vehicles	2.40	315	470	10475	155
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (four to six axles)	3.45	450	680	15060	225
6	Oversized vehicles (seven or more Axles)	4.20	550	825	18330	275

The rates for monthly pass applicable for local personal vehicle shall be Rs.360/- for the year 2026-27.

Project Director,
NHAI Project Implementation Unit, Chennai - 1
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**Government of India**
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)



PUBLIC NOTICE ON REVISED USER FEE RATES
AT MORATTANDI FEE PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS)
The Public are hereby informed that pursuant to Fee Notification Published in the Gazette vide S.O.No.3859 (E) dated 06.09.2024 by MoRTH and approved revised User fee rates vide letter dated 22.07.2026 issued by NHA, the User fee for the use of section from Km.0.000 to Km.37.920 of Pondicherry to Tindivanam Section of NH-32 (old NH-66) for a length of 37.920 Km shall be revised in line with NH Fee Rules 2008 {G.S.R. 838 (E) dated 05.12.2008} and subsequent amendments w.e.f. 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS) at Morattandi Fee Plaza (Km.6.572) near Morattandi Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District in the State of Tamil Nadu at the following rates:-

Sl. No.	Category of vehicles	Fee for single Journey (Rs.)	Fee for Return Journey within a day (Rs.)	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single journeys in a month (in Rupees)	Fee for Single journey for Commercial vehicles registered with in district
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	70	105	2340	35
2	Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	115	170	3780	55
3	Bus or Truck (Two Axle)	240	355	7920	120
4	Three -Axle commercial Vehicle	260	390	8640	130
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (4 to 6 axes)	375	560	12420	185
6	Oversized vehicles (7 or more Axles)	455	680	15125	225

I. The rate of monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within a distance of 20 km from the fee plaza shall be Rs.360/- for FY 2026-27.

II. Annual Pass can be purchased for Rs.3075/- through the Rajmarg Yatra App. This pass is applicable for all private vehicles such as Cars, Jeeps and Vans (Non-Commercial). The pass will be valid for 1 year or 200 Fee Plaza crossings, whichever occurs earlier for FY 2026-27.

DGM (Tech) & Project Director
National Highways Authority of India, Puducherry
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**डॉक्टर हरीसिंह गौर विश्वविद्यालय, सागर (म.प्र.)**
DOCTOR HARISINGH GOUR VISHWAVIDYALAYA, SAGAR (M.P.)
(NAAC A⁺ Accredited Central University / NAAC द्वारा 'A' ग्रेड मान्यता प्राप्त केंद्रीय विश्वविद्यालय)
Website: www.dhgsu.edu.in



स्नातक प्रोग्रामों में प्रवेश हेतु सूचना: 2026–27
ADMISSION NOTICE FOR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMS: 2026-27

Online applications are invited for admission in following Undergraduate Programs (Session: 2026-27):
(1) Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) (2) Bachelor of Fine Arts (B.F.A.) (3) Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com.) (4) Bachelor of Business Administration (B.B.A.) (Hons.) (5) Bachelor of Business Administration (B.B.A. Banking & Finance) (6) Bachelor of Science (B.Sc. Bio. Group) (7) Bachelor of Science (B.Sc. Maths, Group) (8) Bachelor of Computer Application (B.C.A.) (9) Bachelor of Pharmacy (B. Pharm.) (10) B.A.L.L.B (Hons. 5 Yrs.) (11) Bachelor of Arts (Journalism & Mass Communication) (B.A. J.M.C.) (12) Bachelor of Performing Arts (Tabla Percussion) (13) Bachelor of Performing Arts (Hindustani Vocal Music) (14) Bachelor of Arts (Vedic Studies) (Hons.) (15) Bachelor of Arts English Literature (Hons.).

Integrated Education ITEP Programs: (1) B.A. - B.Ed. (2) B.Sc.- B.Ed. (Bio/Maths Group) (3) B.Com. - B.Ed.

Last date of registration	26.07.2026	Contact Details: :	
		Ph. 07582-297123	Email: admission@dhgsu.edu.in

* For admission schedule, latest updates regarding admission, please visit the university website www.dhgsu.edu.in, regularly everyday.

Registrar

CBC 21273/11/0001/2627

**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA**
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)



PUBLIC NOTICE ON REVISED USER FEE RATES AT KOTHATAI FEE PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS)

The Public are hereby informed that pursuant to Fee Notification Published in the Gazette vide S.O.No.4963 (E) dated 13.11.2024 by MoRTH and approved revised User fee rates vide letter dated 22.07.2026 issued by NHAI, the User fee for the use of section from Km.67.000 to Km.123.800 of Poondiyankuppam to Sattanathapuram Section of NH-32 for a length of 56.800 Km in Villupuram to Nagapattinam corridor shall be revised in line with NH Fee Rules 2008 {G.S.R. 838 (E) dated 05.12.2008} and subsequent amendments w.e.f. 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS) at Kothatai Fee Plaza (Km.81.000) near Kothatai Village, Chidambaram Taluk, Cuddalore District in the State of Tamil Nadu at the following rates:-

Amount in Rs.

Sl.No.	Category of Vehicle	Fee for single journey	Fee for return journey within a day	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single journeys in a month	Fee for single journey for Commercial vehicles registered with in district
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	135	200	4420	65
2	Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	215	320	7140	105
3	Bus or Truck (Two Axle)	450	675	14960	225
4	Three-Axle Commercial Vehicles	490	735	16320	245
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (Four to Six Axles)	705	1055	23465	350
6	Oversized Vehicles (Seven or more axles)	855	1285	28565	430

I. The rate of monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within a distance of 20 km from the fee plaza shall be Rs.360/- for FY 2026-27.

II. Annual Pass can be purchased for Rs.3075/- through the Rajmarg Yatra App. This pass is applicable for all private vehicles such as Cars, Jeeps and Vans (Non-Commercial). The pass will be valid for 1 year or 200 Fee Plaza crossings, whichever occurs earlier for FY 2026-27.

DGM (Tech) & Project Director
National Highways Authority of India, Puducherry
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**GOVERNMENT OF INDIA**
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)



PUBLIC NOTICE ON REVISED USER FEE RATES AT SELIYAMEDU FEE PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS)

The Public are hereby informed that pursuant to Fee Notification Published in the Gazette vide S.O.No.3642 (E) dated 06.08.2025 by MoRTH and approved revised User fee rates vide letter dated 21.07.2026 issued by NHAI, the User fee for the use of section from Km 29.000 to Km 67.000 of Puducherry to Poondiyankuppam Section of NH-32 for a length of 30.000 Km in Villupuram to Nagapattinam corridor shall be revised in line with NH Fee Rules 2008 {G.S.R. 838 (E) dated 05.12.2008} and subsequent amendments w.e.f. 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS) at Seliyamedu Fee Plaza (Km 41.500) near Seliyamedu Village, Bahour Taluk, Puducherry District in the State of Puducherry at the following rates:-

Amount in Rs.

Sl. No	Category of Vehicles	Fee for single Journey ₹	Fee for Return Journey within a day ₹	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single journey in a month ₹	Fee for single journey for Commercial vehicles registered with in the district ₹
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	75	115	2500	40
2	Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	120	180	4040	60
3	Bus or Truck (Two Axes)	255	380	8465	125
4	Three-Axle commercial vehicles	275	415	9235	140
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (4 to 6 axes)	400	595	13275	200
6	Oversized Vehicles (7 or more axes)	485	725	16165	240

I. The rate of monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within a distance of 20 km from the fee plaza shall be Rs.360/- for FY 2026-27.

II. Annual Pass can be purchased for Rs.3075/- through the Rajmarg Yatra App. This pass is applicable for all private vehicles such as Cars, Jeeps and Vans (Non-Commercial). The pass will be valid for 1 year or 200 Fee Plaza crossings, whichever occurs earlier for FY 2026-27.

DGM (Tech) & Project Director
National Highways Authority of India, Puducherry
BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS

**Government of India**
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(Ministry of Road Transport and Highways)



PUBLIC NOTICE ON REVISED USER FEE RATES AT GANGARAMPALAYAM FEE PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS)

The Public are hereby informed that pursuant to Fee Notification Published in the Gazette vide S.O.No.4385 (E) dated 08.10.2024 by MoRTH and approved revised User fee rates vide letter dated 22.07.2026 issued by NHA, the User fee for the use of section from Km.0.000 to Km.29.000 of Villupuram to Puducherry Section of NH-332 for a length of 29 Km in Villupuram to Nagapattinam corridor shall be revised in line with NH Fee Rules 2008 {G.S.R. 838 (E) dated 05.12.2008} and subsequent amendments w.e.f. 24.07.2026 (00:00 HRS) at Gangarampalayam Fee Plaza (Km.18.500) near Gangarampalayam Village, Villupuram Taluk, Villupuram District in the State of Tamil Nadu at the following rates:-

Amount in Rs.

Sr. No	Category of vehicles	Fee for single journey	Fee for return journey within a day	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single journeys in a month	Fee for single journey for Commercial vehicles registered with in district
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	65	95	2110	30
2	Light Commercial Vehicles, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	100	155	3405	50
3	Bus / Truck (Two Axle)	215	320	7140	105
4	Three Axle commercial Vehicle	235	350	7790	115
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (4 to 6 axes)	335	505	11195	170
6	Oversized vehicles (7 or more Axles)	410	615	13630	205

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DGM (Tech) & Project Director
National Highways Authority of India, Puducherry
BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS



From Page One

Youth dies days after arrest in Thoothukudi

He was released on station bail on Friday night. But he was admitted to the hospital on the same day by his family, the police said.

Hospital sources said he had been undergoing treatment at the neurosurgery ward.

His family members staged a protest in front of the hospital, alleging that Arunachalam had sustained head injuries owing to custodial torture. They demanded an investigation into the circumstances leading to his death.

A video circulated on social media showed Arunachalam lying on a hospital bed and alleging that he was assaulted by three police personnel. He said the police struck him on the head.

However, in a press release, the Thoothukudi district police said that after his arrest, Arunachalam was taken to the hospital at 5.50 p.m. for a detailed examination. “After the check-up, the attending doctor certified his fitness and noted that he had no external injuries,” the release said. After the examination, he was brought back to the police station to complete the formalities and kept in the station lock-up along with other inmates.

The police said that while he was conversing normally with other inmates, he collapsed in the lock-up. Arunachalam’s mother, who was in the reception area, was called. As his condition appeared normal thereafter, he was released on station bail and sent with his relatives for further medical check-up.

A short video clip showing Arunachalam collapsing inside the lock up was released on Thursday.

The police statement said his relatives later informed the police that he had again collapsed near the hospital and was admitted to the hospital.

A senior police officer said Arunachalam had a medical history of seizures. The police also claimed that he was a habitual offender and had previously been arrested for the possession of contraband.

On a complaint filed by Arunachalam’s father, a case has been registered at the Thoothukudi South police station. The body was sent for post-mortem. Further investigations are under way.

PMK president Anbumani Ramadoss demanded a CBI probe into the death of Arunachalam, alleging that he was assaulted by the police in custody.

Manithaneya Makkal Katchi president and MLA M.H. Jawahirullah demanded an inquiry by a High Court judge. He said the allegations, if proven, would amount to a grave human rights violation. He also expressed concern over what he called a series of custodial deaths in the State.

Vijay’s Jana Nayagan hits the screens across State; cinemas see good footfall

Cinema owners in the southern districts report a noticeable increase in women turning up for ‘first day’ shows. For Friday, most cinemas in Chennai say occupancy levels are around 70%-75%

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Jana Nayagan, starring Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, was released on Thursday, drawing crowds to cinemas across the State. Cinema owners in the southern districts reported a noticeable increase in women turning up for ‘first day’ shows.

Several cinemas and multiplexes in Madurai, Coimbatore, and Tiruchi recorded a healthy occupancy, while smaller screens witnessed a relatively modest footfall of around 40%-50%.

For Friday, most cinemas in Chennai said occupancy levels were hovering around 70%-75%. The big multiplexes reported a full house. However, cinemas in Tier 2 and Tier 3 towns reported bookings of around 40%, with many expecting last-minute bookings at the counters. Even online ticket booking platform BookMyShow had multiple slots available across cinemas.

“On day one, we had TVK cadre booking tickets. A large number of women cadre also came in. In general, we see more women turning up for any of Vijay’s films, but this time the numbers were slightly higher,” said S Jegan Agilan, Managing Partner of Jagan Cinemas in Ramanathapuram.



At long last: Fans of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay celebrating the release of Jana Nayagan at Albert Theatre in Chennai on Thursday. R. RAGU

M. Manoj Kumar, Managing Director of Ganesh Cinemas in Melur, Madurai, said: “We have four screens, and all of them are showing Jana Nayagan this weekend. We’ve seen a mixed audience of families and young women, with the number of women moviegoers being slightly higher than usual.”

Udeep Reddy, Managing Director of Mayajaal, said the movie was running in all 16 screens. “For a film which got pirated, and which most of the fans have watched already, it has achieved a very good opening,” he said.

Social media was abuzz with posts claiming that tickets were being sold at inflated prices in some ci-

nemas. However, two cinema owners pointed out that the majority of tickets are sold online at fixed prices. They said people who purchase tickets online may later resell them in the black market.

“We don’t know who is buying the tickets online. Whoever presents a valid ticket is allowed into the theatre. If movie-goers have paid extra to someone without our knowledge, it is not our responsibility,” a cinema owner said.

In several cinemas in Tiruchi, to cash in on the ‘first day, first show’ craze, tickets were being sold for upwards of ₹500 in the black market, many fans complained. “My son

wanted to watch the film today, but tickets at our local cinema were priced at ₹500, and so I refused. We will have to wait and see the movie on TV or on OTT later,” a parent said.

Most major cinemas in Tiruchi avoided offering bulk bookings to fan clubs to give everyone an opportunity to watch the film. “We have maintained an online system for ticket booking, at ₹190 per ticket. We want everyone to watch the film,” an official from LA Cinemas in Tiruchi said.

In Madurai region, a large number of police personnel were deployed in front of cinema houses where the film was released.

Ministers, MLAs turn emotional during screenings of film

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The release of Jana Nayagan, starring Chief Minister and TVK president C. Joseph Vijay, drew several Ministers and MLAs to cinemas across Tamil Nadu on Thursday, with many of them turning emotional during the screenings.

Considered as Mr. Vijay’s swansong before his transition to full-time politics, Jana Nayagan, which was originally expected to be released ahead of the 2026 Assembly elections, hit the screens on Thursday after a prolonged legal battle to obtain the Central Board of Film Certification’s (CBFC) clearance.

In Chennai, Minister for Rural Development and Water Resources and TVK general secretary N. Anand, and the Minister for Health, Medical Education and Family Welfare and the ruling party’s general secretary (policy and propaganda), K.G. Arunraj, watched the film at Rohini Theatre. Mr. Anand turned emotional during a scene in the film. Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar watched the film at Sathyam Cinemas.

Addressing the media after the film’s release in Tiruchi, M. Ravisankar, Deputy Speaker of the Assembly, said it was sad that Mr. Vijay would no longer be seen on the big screen.

In Coimbatore, Minister for Prohibition and Excise K. Vignesh and Minister for Backward Classes Welfare V. Sampath Kumar watched the film in cinemas packed with Mr. Vi-

jay’s fans. Mr. Vignesh broke down in tears at the end of the screening at Arasan Cinemas in Podanur, while a video showed Mr. Kumar weeping during the screening at Karpagam Theatres on 100-ft. Road.

In Gobichettipalayam, Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management K.A. Sengottaiyan distributed sweets to the public outside a cinema after watching the film. In Arakkonam, fans gathered in large numbers at the cinema where Minister for Cooperation V. Gandhiraj watched the film. In Kancheepuram, Minister for Non-Resident Tamils’ Welfare K. Thennarasu watched the film and described its release as a festival for Mr. Vijay’s fans.

Minister for Labour Welfare and Skill Development J. Mohamed Farvas also became emotional during a screening in Pudukkottai. Minister for Handlooms, Textiles and Khadi M. Vijay Balaji and several MLAs were also seen turning emotional during the screening of the film.

MSME Minister P. Mathan Raja, along with TVK cadre, cut a cake to celebrate the movie’s release in Udthagamandalam.

Madurai North MLA Kallanai joined Mr. Vijay’s fans at a screening in Madurai. He distributed helmets to some of the youth, and appealed to them to obey traffic rules.

Madurai West MLA Thangapandian said Mr. Vijay should continue acting, as cinema was a powerful medium to reach the masses.

Stalin criticises government’s ‘silence’ on Cauvery issue

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Thursday expressed shock over what he described as the State government’s silence on Karnataka’s failure to release Cauvery water to Tamil Nadu.

“The Chief Minister should have met the Prime Minister over this issue, but he has not done so. The Water Resources Minister has also failed to take it up. The Chief Secretary does not appear to have written either to his Karnataka counterpart or to the Union Water Resources Secretary. The government’s silence on such a vital issue is shocking,” he said in a statement.

Mr. Stalin alleged that the TVK-led government had also failed to fulfil its promise of waiving farmers’ loans in full.

‘Replace CWMA’
Meanwhile, PMK leader Anbumani Ramadoss criticised the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) for refusing to direct Karnataka to release water to Tamil Nadu, and demanded that the CWMA be replaced with an empowered Cauvery Management Board.

In a statement, he said the CWMA had accepted Karnataka’s claim that the available water was sufficient only for Bengaluru’s drinking water needs, and declined Tamil Nadu’s request to release water to protect ‘kuruvai’ crops. He said Karnataka had released only 3.44 tmc ft. as against 28.30 tmc ft. due to Tamil Nadu since June.

Minister holds meeting with stakeholders ahead of launch of ‘presence-less’ registration

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Commercial Taxes and Registration D. Logesh Tamilselvan on Thursday chaired a consultative meeting of flat and plot promoters, bankers, and representatives of financial institutions on the ‘presence-less’ registration of certain documents, which will come into force on August 17.

The meeting was held at Amma Maligai on the premises of the Ripon Buildings in Chennai.

Mr. Tamilselvan said the Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay-led government had been working to leverage the potential of information technology in governance to improve the delivery of government



Taking stock: Minister D. Logesh Tamilselvan addressing the meeting held at Amma Maligai in Chennai.

services in a swift, simple, and transparent manner.

The first sale of plots and flats would be covered in the first phase of presence-less registration from August 17. It would significantly reduce the time and money to be spent by the public. As flat and plot promoters, bankers, and financial institutions were the key stakeholders in the system,

training programmes would be organised to create awareness and clarify doubts, the Minister said.

Commercial Taxes, Registration, and Religious Endowments Secretary J. Kumaragurubaran, Inspector-General of Registration G.K. Arun Sundar Thayalan, and other officials were present at the meeting.

IFS officer A. Udhayan made Head of Forest Force

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has appointed senior Indian Forest Service (IFS) officer A. Udhayan as the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Head of Forest Force), the highest post in the Forest Department.

Mr. Udhayan, a 1991-batch IFS officer of the Tamil Nadu cadre, is currently the Director of the Advanced Institute for Wildlife Conservation (AIWC), a position he has held since June 14, 2022. Before taking charge at AIWC, he served as Chairman of the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board.

He will become Head of Forest Force on August 1, succeeding Srinivas R. Reddy, who is due to retire on July 31.

Municipal chairperson moves HC seeking CBI inquiry into registration of Palani math land

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

Chairperson of Palani Municipality R. Uma Maheshwari Pradeep on Thursday filed a petition before the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court, seeking a CBI probe into the case pertaining to fraudulent registration of Palani math land.

Describing herself as a devotee who had a genuine interest in the protection and preservation of the math’s properties, she said the land had been subjected to encroachment and unauthorised occupation by private individuals over the course of several decades.

Though departmental action, including suspension, was initiated against

some Registration Department officials, the role of the supervisory officers and other public servants involved in the processing and registration of the document had not been effectively examined in the criminal investigation, she said.

Besides, the Division Bench of the High Court, which declared the sale deed null and void, had recorded that fraud was evident at every stage of the transaction, from preparation and presentation of the instrument to registration. “The criminal investigation must consequently extend to the complete chain of persons who prepared, financed, presented, processed, facilitated and completed the fraudulent registration. The enor-

mous disparity between the true value of the property and the consideration recorded in the instrument raises a serious question as to whether the document reflects a genuine transaction between the parties,” she said.

She said the probe must trace the complete financial trail, including the source of ₹2 crore, banking transactions, cash withdrawals and deposits, undisclosed considerations, intermediaries, accommodation entries, beneficial ownership, and persons who may have funded or directed the transaction. The possibility of cash dealings, benami arrangement, informal transfer of funds or hawala transactions must be examined, she said.

Vilathikulam MLA moves Madras HC challenging judicial remand order

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

DMK MLA from Vilathikulam G.V. Markandayan, who was arrested for having stated that his party’s legislators would “break the bones” of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay in the Assembly, has approached the Madras High Court, challenging his judicial remand order.

Justice G.K. Ilanthirayan on Thursday adjourned the hearing of the petition to Monday, after hearing preliminary submissions made by senior counsel P. Wilson, appearing for the petitioner, and



G.V. Markandayan

State Public Prosecutor R. John Sathyan, appearing for the Thoothukudi District Crime Branch (DCB) Police, who had arrested the MLA on July 20.

While Mr. Wilson argued that the Thoothukudi

judicial magistrate had failed to appreciate the principles laid down by the Supreme Court on arrests in cases involving a maximum punishment of seven years of imprisonment, Mr. Sathyan sought time till Monday to obtain instructions from the Thoothukudi DCB.

Petition transferred

Though the petition to set aside the remand order and grant bail to the MLA was filed before the Madurai Bench of the High Court, it was transferred to the principal seat in Chennai, since all cases related to MPs and MLAs would

have to be listed only before the portfolio judge here.

In his petition, the MLA had contended that the remand order was liable to be set aside as it had been passed without taking into consideration whether the arrest was necessary in the present case without resorting to other measures such as summoning him for inquiry by issuing notice under Section 41A of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS).

The petitioner said the Thoothukudi DCB had failed to submit before the magistrate the reasons for having concluded that the

arrest of the MLA was absolutely necessary, though the provisions under which he had been booked would lead to a maximum punishment of only seven years of imprisonment.

The arrested MLA also argued that his judicial remand was against the principles laid down by the Supreme Court in Arnesh Kumar vs State of Bihar (2014) and Satendra Kumar Antil vs Central Bureau of Investigation (2022), in which it had been held that notices of inquiry must be issued to the suspects in criminal cases involving a maximum punishment of up to

seven years of imprisonment.

It was also brought to the notice of the court that the DCB had registered the First Information Report (FIR) against the MLA on the basis of a complaint filed by an individual named S. Balasubramanian on July 19, 2026. The complainant was aggrieved by a public speech delivered by the MLA at a meeting organised by the DMK near the Kovilpatti Krishnan temple on July 18. He had accused the MLA of having threatened that his party legislators would “break the bones of the Chief Minister inside

the Legislative Assembly”. Hence, the FIR was registered under Sections 351 (3) (criminal intimidation), 352 (intentional insult with intent to provoke breach of peace), and 353(2) (statements conducing to public mischief) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

The MLA was arrested and remanded in judicial custody on July 20. The magistrate had ordered his remand till August 3, after taking into consideration the gravity of the public speech delivered by him and also the law laid down by the Supreme Court in Arnesh Kumar’s case.

INBRIEF



Kerala suspends ADGP Ajith Kumar over probe tampering

The Kerala government on Thursday decided to suspend Additional Director General of Police (ADGP) M.R. Ajith Kumar over allegations that he interfered in the investigation into the assault on Youth Congress workers by former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan's security detail in Alappuzha in 2023. The suspension move follows the submission of a detailed inquiry report which indicated Mr. Kumar's involvement in attempts to influence the course of the investigation.

Cases booked against 249 guest lecturers in Bengaluru

The Department of Collegiate Education in Bengaluru has ordered the registration of criminal cases against 249 teachers who got placed as guest faculty in government first grade colleges by submitting fake/invalid PhD certificates in the year 2025-26. The State government recruited about 10,000 guest faculty though an online counselling process in 2025-26. The order blacklists these candidates permanently for the years to come as well.

Police constable dies by suicide in Telangana

A police constable posted at the Telangana Director General of Police (DGP)'s Office in Lakdikapul died after allegedly shooting himself of Thursday. Upon receiving the information, the Saifabad police shifted the body for post-mortem examination. A case was booked and further investigation is under way to ascertain the circumstances that led to the incident. (People in distress can call Tele MANAS helpline 14416 or 1800-891-4416)

Ex-TDB chief Prasanth held in Sabarimala gold theft case

He and former Board member A. Ajikumar remanded in judicial custody for 13 days; Prasanth, six others implicated in illegally transporting gold-plated panels from the temple to Chennai in 2025

The Hindu Bureau
KOLLAM

A Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the Sabarimala gold theft case arrested former Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) president P.S. Prasanth and former Board member A. Ajikumar on Thursday. Officers took Mr. Prasanth into custody from his residence in Ennikkara, Thiruvananthapuram, while Mr. Ajikumar, a native of Kayamkulam, was intercepted en route to the capital.

The two accused were remanded in judicial custo-



Former TDB president P.S. Prashanth (right) and former member A. Ajikumar being taken for medical tests on Thursday. C. SURESHKUMAR

dy for 13 days at the Poojappura Central Jail. The arrests follow a recent ultimatum from the Kerala High Court directing the SIT to submit its final chargesheet by the end of this month.

Mr. Prasanth, a former Congress leader who later joined the CPI(M), was appointed devaswom board president following his party switch, while Mr. Ajikumar represented the CPI on the board.

Centre asks Telangana to return ₹54.22 crore

B. Chandrashekhara
HYDERABAD

The Directorate of Monitoring and Appraisal under the Ministry of Jal Shakti (MoJS) has asked the Telangana government (Irrigation Department) to return the Central Assistance of ₹36.34 crore along with interest released, under the Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY) for nine ongoing projects. The amount including interest totals ₹54.22 crore.

In a letter, Director of

M&A noted that the Telangana government had written to it in July 2023 for dropping the proposals submitted for 11 projects in the past and adjust the central assistance release to nine other projects.

Converted to loan The M&A Director pointed out that in case the State government fails to complete the projects as per timeline mentioned, the funds released be converted to loan to the State government.

KPSC recruitment exam under scanner

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Amidst allegations of nepotism and malpractice by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) chairman, who has been suspended by the Governor for the same, the Commission is in the eye of the storm again over alleged corruption in recruitment exam.

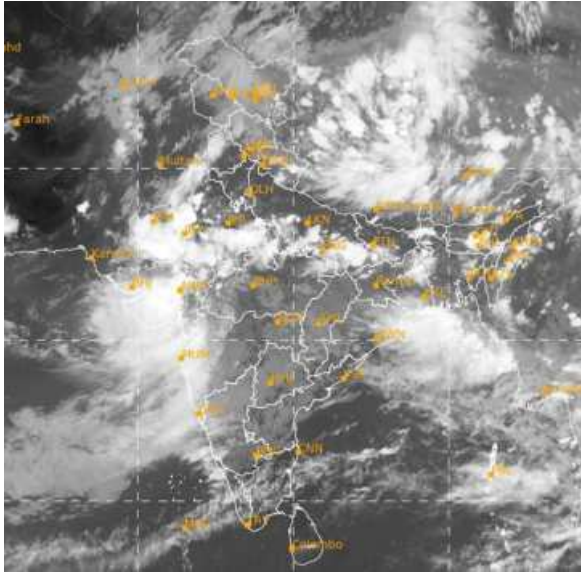
Hundreds of candidates who appeared for the recruitment of Veterinary Officer posts gathered in

front of the Vidhana Soudha Police Station in Bengaluru on Thursday and submitted a complaint.

In the complaint submitted to the police, aspirants have made allegations against the now-suspended KPSC chairman illegally benefiting his daughters, a candidate related to a top official of KPSC figures in the final list. The candidate who failed in the veterinary course and is a repeater secured a high score in the KPSC exam, they alleged.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Gujarat, Rajasthan, Jammu & Kashmir, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Konkarn & Goa and Karnataka. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal and Kerala

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	25.4	30.8	24.8	Kurnool	—	33.5	24.6
Ahmedabad	5.3	27.0	24.8	Lucknow	—	32.5	27.0
Aizawl	—	31.2	23.8	Madurai	—	39.4	26.7
Bengaluru	—	30.1	20.8	Mangaluru	43.1	28.7	23.4
Bhopal	40.7	27.5	23.0	Mumbai	—	63.6	28.5
Bhubaneswar	—	32.0	23.6	Mysuru	—	31.2	20.2
Chandigarh	2.7	34.7	24.8	New Delhi	—	34.5	27.2
Chennai	—	37.5	28.3	Patna	1.6	32.8	26.8
Coimbatore	—	32.3	22.6	Port Blair	—	4.3	31.0
Dehradun	—	32.0	23.5	Prayagraj	0.1	32.2	26.0
Gangtok	25.8	21.5	16.8	Puducherry	—	35.0	28.2
Goa	21	30.2	24.2	Pune	4.5	27.5	24.3
Guwahati	7.4	32.0	26.2	Raipur	—	21	27.2
Hubballi	—	30.0	22.0	Ranchi	8	27.3	21.0
Hyderabad	11.7	27.7	22.8	Shillong	13	24.8	16.8
Imphal	0.2	31.3	21.3	Shimla	—	21.2	16.8
Jaipur	7.2	32.9	25.6	Srinagar	—	15.6	21.6
Kochi	9.6	31.0	25.0	Thiruvananthapuram	—	33.8	25.1
Kohima	—	24.0	19.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	37.1	27.4
Kolkata	10.9	38.8	26.0	Vijayawada	—	36.6	26.6
Kozhikode	23.4	33.3	24.6	Visakhapatnam	—	31.8	28.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	51	60	101	45	58	■	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Banswara,
Bengaluru	13	29	56	—	110	■	Rajasthan recorded an
Chennai	5	25	36	14	190	■	overall air quality index
Delhi	7	29	47	117	163	■	(AQI) score of 241
Hyderabad	12	12	39	34	53	■	indicating an unhealthy
Kolkata	14	22	48	73	87	■	level of pollution. In
Lucknow	6	22	66	48	51	■	contrast, Gangtok, Sikkim
Mumbai	8	73	31	24	68	■	recorded a healthy AQI
Pune	18	74	26	43	43	■	score of 13
Visakhapatnam	21	55	18	35	118	■	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM No.6

Tender No. 27.28.3866. Dept/Rly. STORES/CENTRAL RAILWAY **Closing: 03.08.2026.** **Tender Title:** Oil Cooling Radiator. **Field Name-Tender Opening Date/Time:** Existing Date 22.06.2026 11.30 **Modified Date** 03.08.2026 11.30. **Consignee:** Field Name - Quantity: Existing Qty 155 Nos. **Modified Qty.** 250 Nos. **Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense**

CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

It is hereby notified that the work published under **open e-tender Notice No. CR-DRMWB-2026-35**, Sr. No. 04 and 05, which are due to be opened on 31.07.2026 the name of work for **Sr. No. 04**, shall be read as Ghansoli, Rabale, Seawood-Darave, Baramandongri & Kharkopar : Repairs to Railway Offices & Toilets, Platform wall, Coping & platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT and for **Sr. No. 05** shall be read as Jinanagar & Sanpada: Repairs to Railway offices & Toilets, Platform wall, Coping & Platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT section. **Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense**

WESTERN RAILWAY

CONSTRUCTION WORK

Dy. Chief Engineer (Construction)-II, Western Railway, Pratapnagar, Vadodara-390004 invites **Tender Notice No: DYCEC-II-ROB-3 Dated 23.07.2026** Nos Name of the Work: Construction of 2 lane ROB in lieu of Level Crossings no. 33 (Km :30/1-3) (Railway & approach portion) of Anand Godhra section, Level Crossings no. 44 (Km :39/15-40/1) (Railway & approach portion) of Anand Godhra section & 4 lane ROB in lieu of Level Crossings 220 (KM :37/9-37/8/0) (Railway & approach portion) of Surat Vadodara section including foundation, substructure & Super structure, Girder work and approaches using PSC/RC Girder on Viaduct, Return wall, earthwork, Roadwork and (Railway portion) including foundation, substructure & Super structure, Girder work & other Misc. works under the jurisdiction of CE-C-II-CCG of Vadodara Division Western Railway, Approx. Cost of Work: ₹215,04,06,124.70/- EMD: ₹4,30,08,100/- Date of opening of Bid From: 23.07.2026 To: On 06.08.2026 at 15.00 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.ireps.gov.in. **0403** Follow us on: X.com/WesternRly

MP POORV KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
BLOCK NO.7, SHAKTI BHAWAN, RAMPUR, JABALPUR (M.P.)
Tel No:0761 2702473, Fax No:0761-2660048, CIN: U40109MP2002SG015120, e-mail : cepurez@yahoo.in
No. CGM/S&P/EZ/GM-VII/1007 Jabalpur, dtd:- 21.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Online tenders are invited for AMC, FMS and Onsite Support of UPS and Non-IT Equipment's installed at Data Center & IT Cell under RAPDRP, ERP, SCADA, MPPMCL, Project(s) at MPPKVVCL, Jabalpur as per tender specifications. The Bids will be received online on the portal <https://mptenders.gov.in> up to date & time as per key dates. The tender will be opened in the office of undersigned as mentioned in tender time schedule (key dates) in presence of bidders duly authorized representative who may like to be present at the time of opening of tender: -

Sr. No.	T.S. No. (For e-Tendering) DISCOM/EZ/PUR	NAME OF ITEMS	APPROX. VALUE (Rs. in Lakhs)	TENDER FEE (in Rs)	Due date & times of Opening of Tender(*)
1	1742 (E-Tender No. 2026_PKVVC_S23029_1)	AMC, FMS AND ONSITE SUPPORT OF UPS AND NON-IT EQUIPMENT'S INSTALLED AT DATA CENTER & IT CELL UNDER RAPDRP, ERP, SCADA, MPPMCL, PROJECT(S) AT MPPKVVCL, JABALPUR	182.00	5,900.00	21.08.2026

*For updated/extended due dates for opening of tender (EMD in Cover -1 & Techno-commercial bid in Cover-2) please refer to the online key dates.

SAVE ENERGY FOR BETTER TOMORROW | बिजली संबंधी शिकायतों के निराकरण के लिए 1912 डायल करें? C.G.M (S&P)

Civil Aviation Department
Patna Airport, Patna – 800014
TEL. No:- 0612-2225659, 2224423, e-mail-cadbihar@bihar.gov.in

Letter. No: सि०नि०वि (संचारण) 14–05/2026– 1001

Tender Notice

Sealed tender under **TWO BID SYSTEM** is hereby invited by the Govt. of Bihar from Insurance Companies licensed by IRDAI or Insurance brokerage firm for renewal of Aviation Insurance Policy for **04 Training Aircraft Cessna 172 *R*** for a period of one year as per the following terms and conditions:-

- Bid submission starts from **24.07.2026** Tender Schedule has been provided in Sl. No-11 of this Notice.
- The tender must reach to Secretary, Civil Aviation Department, Patna Airport, Patna on or before **19.08.2026 at 05:00 PM**, by registered post/speed post/courier or by hand only.
- Tender can be submitted directly by companies or through Insurance brokerage firm.
- Bidders shall submit their offer in **two separate sealed envelopes** one as Technical Bid and other as Financial Bid. The type of Bid must be written on each envelope (Technical/ Financial Bid). These two bids shall be kept in another big envelope which should be sealed and subscribed, “**Tender for Insurance of 04 Training Aircraft Cessna 172 *R* for 01 year**”.
- Aviation Insurance Policy of **04 Training Aircraft Cessna 172 *R*** is due for renewal from **11th October, 2026 for 01 year i.e. Period of Insurance is 11.10.2026 to 10.10.2027**. Aircraft is mainly used for Training flying. Details of the Aircraft is as follow:-

Registration Mark	Make, Type & Series No.	Year of Manufacturing	Seating Capacity	Date of Expiry of Last ARC	Maximum All up weight (Kg.)
VT- ACM	CESSNA – USA/ENG NO- L-36033-51E CESSNA172R 17281427	2007	1 + 3	24.12.2026	1115
VT- BFB	CESSNA – USA/ENG NO- L-36029-51E CESSNA172R 17280739	1999	1 + 3	21.12.2026	1112.3
VT- BFC	CESSNA – USA/ENG NO- L-37121-51E CESSNA172R 17280740	1999	1 + 3	21.03.2027	1112.3
VT- BFD	CESSNA – USA/ENG NO- L-37124-51E CESSNA172R 17280743	1999	1 + 3	25.02.2027	1112.3

- The Technical bid of the tender will be opened tentatively on **21.08.2026 at 3.00 PM** before the committee headed by Secretary, Civil Aviation Department, Bihar, Patna or by an officer so authorized by him before bidders/ authorized representatives.
- Tender Schedule:-**

Sl.No	Activity	Date & Time
1	Bid Submission Start Date	From 24.07.2026
2	Physical Bid Submission (both Technical & Financial Bid) Last Date	Up to 19.08.2026 at 05:00 PM
3	Technical Bid & Financial Bid Opening Date (Tentative)	21.08.2026 at 3.00 PM
4	Tender Bid Validity	90 Days

- The tender notice and details of spare parts can be seen on departmental website <http://state.bihar.gov.in/cad>
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR. No. 008600 (CAD) 2026-27

Secretary
Civil Aviation Department

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रह घर परिवार।

BUSINESS CONNECT

CHPA Signs MoUs

Chennai Port Authority (ChPA), under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, signed MoUs with beneficiary organisations for CSR projects during FY 2026–27. The ceremony was attended by Shri Sachin S. Kurve, IAS, Chairperson; S. Viswanathan, Deputy Chairperson; Ms. Anugraha P., IAS; and other Heads of Departments. The CSR initiatives demonstrated ChPA's commitment to inclusive growth, education, healthcare, public safety, skill development, environmental sustainability, and community welfare. Total CSR allocation is Rs. 8,22,50,000, including significant projects like Rs. 1,00,00,000 for Greater Chennai Corporation and Rs. 82,50,000 for Madras Medical College. Shri Kurve stated, “CSR is our responsibility towards creating an inclusive society,” while the Deputy Chairperson emphasised, “creating opportunity and empowering community.”

GIRIAS Launching at Redhills

Girias recently announced the grand opening of GIRIAS in Redhills that will take place on July 31, 2026. On the occasion of the launch, Customers will enjoy exciting gifts and unbeatable inaugural offers on a diverse range of leading brands. The customers can also benefit from the amazing deals on home appliances, electronics, mobiles, laptops, televisions, kitchen appliances, and much more. Customers, alongside the latest products can also take advantage of exclusive opening-day benefits, including easy EMI options. Girias is excited to come to Redhills and celebrate Launch-day with you. So mark your calendars for July 31st.

Lalithaa Jewellers’ ‘Double Deal’

Lalithaa Jewellers’ ‘Double Deal’ offers customers 1 Percent less on V.A. Charges for gold jewellery, providing better value per gram. Additionally, there's an extra Rs. 150 per gram on Old Jewellery Exchange, above the market rate. Gold Coins can be purchased at just 1 percent V.A. during the Aadi Offer, valid from July 18 to Aug 16. This Aadi, Lalithaa combines tradition, trust, and value, making it a preferred time for savings. Chairman Kiran Kumar emphasises giving customers maximum value for their money, ensuring lower prices without compromising quality. Diamond jewellery is available at Rs.6000 less per carat, while silverware comes with no wastage or making charges on 90 percent of items, reinforcing Lalithaa's commitment to transparent pricing.

A Business Initiative
GRT’s Aadi Thanga Thiruvizha

GRT Jewellers is renowned for its exceptional craftsmanship and significant contributions to community welfare through CSR initiatives in Healthcare and Education. With 68 showrooms, 67 in South India and one in Singapore, the brand offers a diverse range of Gold, Diamond, Platinum, Silver, and Gemstone jewellery. This season, GRT Jewellers celebrates regional festivals with its special “Aadi Thanga Thiruvizha” campaign in Tamil Nadu and Pondicherry. Customers can enjoy Rs.200 off per gram on Gold Jewellery and additional discounts on old Gold Exchange, Diamonds, and Silver Articles. Mr. G.R. ‘Anand’ Ananthapadmanabhan and Mr. G.R. Radhakrishnan invite customers to take advantage of these limited-period offers and explore their extensive collections.

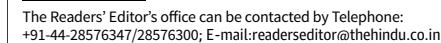
VBJ’S ‘AMAZING AADI SALE’

VBJ announced the launch of its ‘Amazing Aadi Sale’, until 16th August 2026, across gold, diamond, platinum, silver, solitaire and precious stone jewellery. As part of the Sale, customers can avail 20 percent off on making charges and value addition (VA), 3-5 percent off on solitaire diamonds and 10 percent off on silver jewellery. These offers are valid across VBJ showrooms at Anna Salai and Anna Nagar. Mr. Amarendran Vummidi, MP, VBJ, said, “We look forward to welcoming customers this festive season with our Amazing Aadi Sale and helping them celebrate every occasion with timeless creations.” Mr. Jithendra Vummidi, MPPartner, VBJ, added “At VBJ, every collection is thoughtfully designed to cater to diverse tastes and occasions, while staying true to our legacy of fine craftsmanship.”

Kaleesuwari Group’s Scholarships

The Kaleesuwari Foundations presented the GNGA Scholarships to 114 UG. Since 2021, this initiative has provided financial assistance toward college fees in memory of the founder's parents, Gurusamy Nadar and Guruvathai Ammal. 718 students have benefited from the program. The foundation sponsors life-saving heart surgeries, strengthens infrastructure at government hospitals and PHCs, and engages in environmental conservation. Scholarship recipients were selected through a thorough screening process.

CM YK CH-CE



From Page One

PM addresses students; Wangchuk ends fast

The CJP had earlier asked the Ministers to meet the delegation at Jantar Mantar or any other neutral venue.

Among the changes in the Education Department, Naresh Pal Gangwar, who was serving as the secretary in the Ministry of Animal Husbandry, has now been appointed Higher Education Secretary. T.K. Anil Kumar, an additional secretary in the Ministry of Rural Development, has been brought in as the School Education Secretary, another post which was held by Mr. Joshi.

Earlier in the day, in his first outreach to the protesters three days after the CJP-led march to Parliament, Mr. Modi announced the setting up of fast-track courts to swiftly handle cases of paper leaks. He said the welfare of the youth was the top priority of his government and asserted that anyone trying to harm their future will not be spared. But the CJP said the proposal did not address the issue of accountability or the resignation of Mr. Pradhan.

Following the Prime Minister’s announcement, the Delhi High Court notified a designated court to deal with criminal cases arising from paper leaks as well as the use of other unfair means in public examinations. The special court will function from the Rouse Avenue Court Complex.

Earlier on Thursday, Mr. Singh said that the Centre had approached the CJP for talks four times in the past 24 hours. He said a meeting can be held either at Mr. Nadda’s official residence or office, adding that Mr. Modi was “sensitive” to the issue of the paper leak and that “the government was not sitting on prestige”.

While the CJP refused to engage with the government, inside Parliament the Opposition stepped up its attack. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi accused the Modi government of destroying the education system and using force against students. “You allowed and encouraged the total capture and destruction of our education system - and protected every person responsible for it,” Mr. Gandhi wrote on X. Mr. Kharge asked the government to “(c)ome out of your air-conditioned ivory towers and look into the eyes of the young men and women who bled on the streets.”

Government sources said that as of now, all cases of paper leak under the NTA, will be dealt under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. “Centre will soon be asking States and respective high courts to set up fast-track courts to deal with cases,” the sources said.

The Jantar Mantar protest site remained under a heavy security cover and traffic was disrupted in parts of central Delhi for the second consecutive day. 17 metro stations in Delhi remained shut on Thursday and mobile Internet was suspended in parts of central Delhi till midnight within a 1.5-km radius of Jantar Mantar. The CJP has also called for a nationwide agitation on Friday, asking its supporters to protest in every district.

(With PTI inputs)

Houthi attacks drive Brent price past \$100

Thursday’s attacks comes close on the heels of Ukraine targeting Russian merchant ships, including oil tankers, off the port of Novorossiysk, a Russian city on the Black Sea coast. Ukraine has claimed more than 180 hits on Russian ships in the Black Sea in July. On July 17 and 19, Russia attacked two ships off Odesa, a Ukrainian port on the Black Sea, killing four Indian seafarers.

Saudi Arabia currently supplies around 0.4 million barrels per day (mbpd) to India, via Yanbu and Bab al-Mandab. India’s crude oil imports are a little less than 5 mbpd. “A disruption may mean cargoes may need to be rerouted via the Suez Canal, into the Mediterranean and around Africa, but that will take much longer and come with higher freight costs,” says Pankaj Srivastava, a senior vice president at Rystad Energy.

Mr. Srivastava says India imported 2.25 mbpd of Russian crude in June, with nearly 0.7 mbpd originating from Novorossiysk. “If the disruption persists or infrastructure damage is more extensive, India could face additional pressure in securing replacement crude volumes,” he says, adding that the immediate impact is likely to remain manageable.

Since the Houthi hijacking of the car carrier *Galaxy Leader* in November 2023, ship traffic across the Suez Canal had plummeted. It picked up in January this year, however, and surged in March, as Yanbu became an alternative to the Strait of Hormuz. The Houthis have cited Saudi Arabia’s “blockade of supplies” and the attack on Sanaa international airport in Yemen on July 13 as reasons for their blockade. Reuters has, however, reported that Iran is inspiring the Houthi blockade of Saudi oil-carrying ships.

Shipping industry sources say insurance rates climbed 10 to 15 times as soon as the Houthis announced their blockade on July 20, nearly matching rates for the Strait of Hormuz. Meanwhile, the U.S.-based think tank, Institute for the Study of War, said that at least seven vessels have already diverted their routes to avoid the Bab al-Mandab Strait as a consequence of the tanker attacks.

Erik Grundt, Rystad Energy’s senior market analyst, says: “In sailing-time terms, the detour through the Suez Canal and around Africa stretches the Yanbu-to-India (west coast) voyage from about eight days to nearly 39 days.” Compounding this, VLCCs are too large to transit the Suez Canal fully loaded, so they must partially offload at Ain Sukhna and reload at Sidi Kerir on the Mediterranean side, adding time and complexity.

Protests over paper leak intensify in States

Student outfits, civil society groups, and political parties hit the streets demanding resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan; protest marches turn confrontational in several districts of Kerala; police stop protesters in A.P.; security personnel resort to baton-charge in Bihar

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

What began as a protest at Jantar Mantar against the paper leak in the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET) over a month ago snowballed into a nationwide agitation on Thursday, with student outfits, civil society groups and political parties hitting the streets and demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, while criticising the police crackdown on protesters in Delhi.

In Chennai, the protests sought the scrapping of NEET. Amid the ongoing agitation by the Cockroach Janta Party-Tamil Nadu and the All India Student Federation (AISF) at the Communist Party of India office, a demonstration was also organised by the Neelam Student Movement. The Democratic Youth Federation of India, the Student Federation of India (SFI), and over 500 students of New College at Royapettah in the heart of the city joined the cause.

Across Kerala, the SFI took out protest marches that turned confrontational in several districts as police used water cannon and tear gas to disperse the crowds. Marches were



Students staging a protest in Bhopal on Thursday demanding the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan and, right, police use water cannons to disperse activists of Students Federation of India protesting in Thiruvananthapuram. A.M. FARUQUI; NIRMAL HARINDRAN

held in Kochi, Pathanamthitta, Alappuzha, Thrissur, Palakkad and Kannur, while protesters clashed with police in Kasaragod and faced water cannon in Palakkad and Kannur.

‘Chalo Lok Bhavan’
The “Chalo Lok Bhavan” protest organised by student and youth organisations in Andhra Pradesh turned tense after the police stopped them midway. They said Friday’s proposed educational institutions’ bandh would be intensified and the agitation would continue in phases until the Education Minister resigned.

In Uttar Pradesh’s Lucknow, Bhim Army activists tried to march towards the Governor’s residence,

clashed with the police when stopped, and were detained. The Sanyukt Chhatra Manch organised a march in Prayagraj, leading to a brief face-off with the police. Protests were also held in Ghazipur, Varanasi, Ballia, and Azamgarh.

The Aam Aadmi Party’s Chandigarh unit extended support to activist Sonam Wangchuk and demanded Mr. Pradhan’s resignation. Party workers and social activists in Mandi, Himachal Pradesh, criticised the police action in Delhi.

Besides, the student agitation in Madhya Pradesh’s Indore gathered momentum as more students, teachers and parents joined in solidarity with the Delhi protests, leading



to a heavy police deployment. Student groups expressed their grievances in Bhopal. Hundreds of working professionals, organisations such as the Dalit Sangharsha Samithi and the All India Students’ Association (AISA), gathered in Karnataka’s Bengaluru to voice their anguish.

The Delhi protests also resonated in the northeastern States. In Assam, students’ organisations, including the All Assam Students’ Union, the All Assam Minority Students’ Union, and the All Assam Tribal Students’ Union came together.

Students, activists, and political leaders sought education reforms in Guwahati, where the protest was organised under the

ests were also organised in Bhagalpur and Darbhanga districts, and marches taken out in Patna, Munger, Sheikhpura and Vaishali. In Patna, members of AISA and the All India Progressive Women’s Association (AIPWA) extended support to those gathered at Jantar Mantar.

The Jan Sangharsh Manch Haryana and the Students’ Organisation for Socialist Democracy activists took to the streets in Haryana’s Kurukshetra. Leaders of all major Khap Panchayats in the district came together and in Jind, the district bar association suspended work for a day in support.

Chhattisgarh’s capital Raipur saw the police booking nearly a dozen Congress workers under non-bailable provisions.

The Biju Janata Dal’s (BJD) youth wing staged a demonstration in Odisha, where all the Opposition parties have intensified their agitation along with students’ outfits. In Maharashtra, the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) saw chaotic scenes with Opposition parties demanding a discussion on the police action against agitators in Delhi.

Various students’ wings, such as AISA and SFI, organised rallies in several localities of Kolkata.

Over two decades on, two CBI cases in 2003 CAT leak still pending in courts

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

More than two decades after the 2003 Common Admission Test (CAT) paper leak, two Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) cases against Ranjit Singh, alias Ranjit “Don” – described as an “education mafia” figure in some media reports – remain pending before courts in Delhi and Patna. The Patna case is at the trial stage, while the proceedings in the other case are yet to reach that point.

It was on November 22, 2003, that the Delhi Police Crime Branch received a tip-off about the CAT paper leak and its sale, a day ahead of the examination. A police officer contacted one intermediary, who agreed to sell the paper.

Further investigation led them to an examina-

The Patna case is at the trial stage, while proceedings in the Delhi case are yet to reach that point

tion candidate and they found that those willing to buy the solved question paper were being taken to a Mahipalpur hotel in South-West Delhi. The police were pursuing various leads when they discovered that the CBI had raided the place.

Based on its findings, the police arrested several accused persons. They alleged that Kumar Suman Singh alias Ranjit, already arrested by the CBI, was the mastermind behind the leak.

The 2003 CAT paper leak led to the cancellation of the examination. This was the case which brought Ranjit, who be-

longs to Bihar’s Nalanda district, into national focus. As alleged by the probe agency, he had brought his associates to Delhi for arranging candidates.

In the Delhi case, the CBI submitted its chargesheet in early 2004. The agency stated that it initially received information about the suspected roles of Ranjit and his aides in pilfering the paper and delivering it at the Mahipalpur hotel to the candidates.

During a surprise check at the hotel, the CBI allegedly found Arun Kumar Sinha, Ranjit and his other aides in two rooms. Different sections of the question paper were seized allegedly from Ranjit’s possession. The agency also recorded statements of candidates, alleging that ₹2 lakh to ₹4 lakh were de-

manded from them.

The CAT 2003 paper had been printed at the IBPS press in Mumbai. The CBI alleged that Arun and Hari Shankar had visited Mumbai on October 27, 2003, and met accused Sanjeev Kumar, then a daily-wage worker at the press, who handed over the question paper to Arun. A sum of ₹18 lakh was allegedly paid to Sanjeev’s father Yogendra Prasad and ₹3.25 lakh to him in Mumbai.

Arun then took the help of Mohammed Shahin for solving the question paper, as per the CBI, which chargesheeted Ranjit and several others. In this case, “argument on charge” started in July 2019 before a Delhi court and the further necessary proceedings are under way.

The next date of hearing is on July 28.

15 of 39 posts in NTA are vacant, Centre informs Rajya Sabha

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Fifteen of the 39 posts created by the National Testing Agency (NTA) remain vacant, Union Minister of State for Education Sukanta Majumdar stated in Rajya Sabha.

At present, the Union Education Ministry’s exam-conducting body has 24 employees, all of whom have been appointed on deputation from various institutions, Mr. Majumdar stated in a written reply on Wednesday to a question raised by CPI(M) MP V. Sivadasan.

According to the reply, the NTA relies heavily on external hiring, engaging 73 officials on contract – including a general manager of communication, senior advisors, and consultants – alongside 124 outsourced personnel covering roles like data analysis, legal support, and housekeeping.



single dedicated, permanent cadre is a massive administrative failure that directly impacts students,” Mr. Sivadasan said in a public statement.

Since its inception in 2018, the NTA – designed as a self-sustained autonomous organisation – has conducted 270 examinations catering to over 6.6 crore students. In 2026 alone, 65 lakh students have registered for various examinations, the Rajya Sabha reply said. “Despite this enormous scale, the agency has faced intense criticism over paper leaks and test cancellations, including the high-profile mismanagement seen in exams like NEET and UGC-NET,” Mr. Sivadasan said.

The CPI(M) MP also said that although public reports suggest question paper leaks in nearly 100 exams and around 50 re-examinations since 2018, the Ministry of Education has not replied to his question regarding the exact number of re-examinations conducted.

Delhi Police, Centre silent on use of force on protesters

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Three days since videos of police using disproportionate force against unarmed men and women during the July 20 march to Parliament emerged on social media, the Delhi Police and the Union Home Ministry are yet to clarify their position.

Though Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Thursday that “a series of steps for safeguarding the interests of students” were being taken, there was no assurance from the Centre on probing the “police excesses”. The Delhi High Court has sought responses from the Centre and Delhi Police on PIL pleas alleging excessive use of force.

Mumbai policeman threatens protesters; investigation begins

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

The Mumbai Police on Thursday ordered an inquiry and removed a policeman from his current posting pending inquiry after a viral video was posted by the Congress in which the policeman, a driver with the Mumbai Police, is seen threatening protesting students.

A delegation of Maharashtra Congress led by its president Harshawardhan Sapkal met Maharashtra Director General of Police Sadanand Date and Mumbai Police Commissioner Deven Bharti, seeking action against the person. In a memorandum submitted to the police, the Congress also sought immediate re-

lease of the detained students in Mumbai.

“If I see you around here again, then it will not be good for you. I will directly plant 50 grams of powder. Then your life is gone. You won’t get bail. We are in trouble because of you all. Don’t come back,” the person in uniform is seen telling two youth in the video. The Hindu could not verify the authenticity of the clip.

Soon after the video went viral on Thursday morning, the police ordered an inquiry. “Mumbai Police has ordered an inquiry into the matter and action will be taken after verifying the facts. The driver has been removed from the place of his present posting...,” an official of Mumbai Police said.

Delhi HC to hear PIL plea for probe into CJP protest

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court agreed to hear on Friday a public interest litigation (PIL) petition seeking an investigation into the Cockroach Janta Party-led protest at Jantar Mantar.

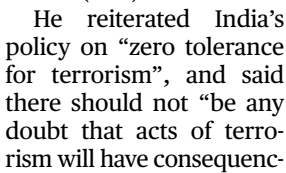
Petitioner Satish Kumar Aggarwal, former vice president of the Akhil Bharat Hindu Mahasabha, said in his plea that the participation of activists, political leaders and the alleged involvement of foreign-funded organisations, has raised questions about the “true nature of the protest”. Mr. Aggarwal’s counsel said, “They have made the entire Delhi hostage. Roads have been blocked. Citizens are suffering.”

APPEAL
Master Yuvaan Duwani, Christian Medical College Hospital No.A155662, 5 years is Diagnosed to have Thalassemia major. This is a type of Blood Disorder which is life Threatening. The treatment option for him would be to undergo Allogeneic Stem cell Transplantation (PBSCT). The Estimated cost of MJUD Transplant at our Hospital will come to Approximately Rs.40,00,000/-
Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives A/c** Yuvaan Duwani, **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487, S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksb. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.
SAVE POOR LIVES, Flat No. A1, Ceebros Garden, Door No.14/76, Kamarajar Salai, Raja Annamalaiapuram, Chennai-600028. Ph. No. 044 42044165 / 9884607377. Email: savepoorlives@gmail.com. Our website: www.savepoorlives.com

Multiple agencies concluded their search and rescue operation after the bodies of all 25 workers trapped inside an under-construction tunnel of a hydropower project in Sikkim's Namchi district were recovered by Thursday evening, District Magistrate Anupa Tamling told *The Hindu*. According to the National Hydroelectric Power Corporation, 25 workers were about 1.5 km inside the tunnel when "sudden explosive release of suspected methane gas" caused an explosion at 1.04 p.m. on July 20. However, the Central PSU and the Sikkim government announced separate investigations into the cause of the accident.

The CBI said that during its investigation, each person involved in the theft and onward distribution of the stolen NEET-UG 2024 question paper was identified, as also each candidate who benefited from its use. “Multiple chargesheets have accordingly been filed by the CBI against 45 persons before the jurisdictional court in Patna,” said the agency.

He said India will be



South China Sea

He informed the EAS of the Indian position on South China Sea and said that India supports the "conclusion of a substantive, effective and legally binding Code of Conduct (CoC), fully compliant with UNCLOS 1982 that does not prejudice the legitimate rights of all users". Continuing with the theme, he

ning with the theme, he

for terrorism”, and said there should not “be any doubt that acts of terrorism will have consequen-

The State government informed the court that the chargesheet had already been filed and that the trial was yet to reach the stage of framing of charges.

against the directions put in place by Supreme Court. "Terrorism cannot be defeated through bulldozers or mass arrests alone. People are essential for restoring lasting peace. People are angry over the brutal killing of the police head constable. But when thousands of people are detained, that anger gets redirected. We must take our people along in this fight; only then will we succeed," he said.

Puranas and other scriptural works instruct devotees to develop bhakti towards the Lord; they also enjoin upon the devotees to follow the instructions of the spiritual guru. Devotion is the root of gna. One should always think of Him. If one speaks at all, it should be about Siva.

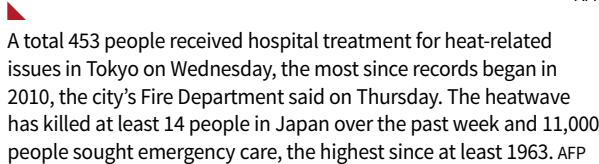
Wipro Consumer Care & Lighting on Thursday signed definitive agreements to acquire TTK Healthcare Ltd.'s Good Home and Eva brands. The combined purchase value for these two brands is ₹256 crore, according to industry sources. The two brands together reported revenues of ₹148 crore in FY26. The acquisition marks Wipro Consumer Care's 17th acquisition and expands its portfolio across home care, air care and fragrance categories.

IndiGo on Thursday reported a ₹238 crore net loss for the three months ended June as higher fuel prices and the West Asia conflict resulted in turbulence for the country's largest airline. The airline had a profit of ₹2,176.3 crore in the year-a-go period. In the first quarter of the current fiscal, InterGlobe Aviation saw its total income rise to ₹25,614.1 crore from ₹21,542.6 crore a year ago. However, overall expenses surged during the same period, said a release. PTI

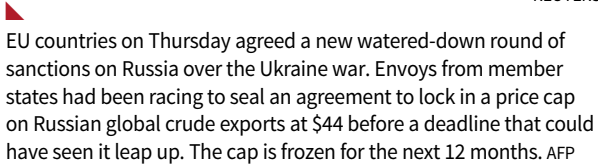
Drugmaker Cipla's consolidated net profit for the quarter ended June declined 39% to ₹785.55 crore compared with the ₹1,291.61 crore in the year earlier on the back of lower sales in the key North America market. The net profit came on a more than 2% increase in total revenue from operations to ₹7,119.28 crore (₹6,957.47 crore). Contributing to the revenue growth was a 12% rise in India business to ₹3,452 crore (₹3,070 cr.).

M CH-CH₂

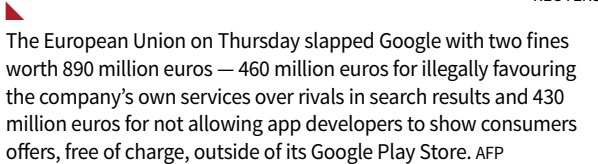
Hundreds hospitalised over the past week as heatwave grips Japan



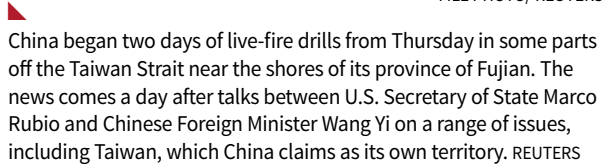
EU locks in oil price cap in new Russia sanctions over Ukraine war



EU fines Google 890 mn euros over search, Play Store violations

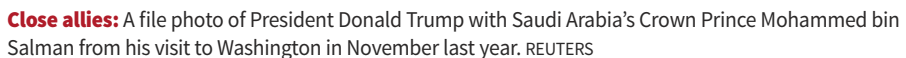


China begins drills off Taiwan Strait a day after talks with Rubio



Trump says the deal is contingent on Riyadh normalising relations with Israel; critics warn it could set off an arms race in the Gulf; while reports suggest U.S. companies could build a uranium enrichment facility in the kingdom, Trump says 'no'

Washington has sought in recent years to tie any nuclear agreement and defence pact to Saudi normalisation with Israel, and just hours after the deal was announced, Mr. Trump took to social media to say Riyadh must first meet that condition.



Concern of enrichment

Critics have insisted the deal – the text of which was not immediately made public – could precipitate a nuclear race in a region already battered by war. One provision would

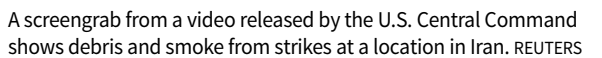
The U.S. Energy Department made no mention of such a provision and did not offer comment when asked about it by AFP, while Mr. Trump added in his Truth Social post that: “There will be no enrichment of material!”

The deal will be submit-

“Trump claims his war on Iran is about stopping

The United States has agreements governing nuclear cooperation with more than 50 countries.

The developments followed new U.S. strikes on Iranian military targets, with U.S. Central Command reporting its 12th consecutive night of strikes, saying it aimed to “further degrade Iran’s



The Houthis said they had carried out missile and drone strikes on two Saudi tankers in the Red Sea, the *Encelia* and the *Layla*, after declaring a blockade of Saudi ports.

In recent weeks, Iran has hit tankers using a route hugging the Omani coast to traverse the strait, in a bid to strong-arm vessels into using its own waters along its coast and pay for safe passage.

The U.S. Capitol in Washington.

An additional \$10 billion would go towards election-related programmes as part of Mr. Trump's push to enact new nationwide

On Thursday, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said spoke with U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner in a bid to revive stalled talks aimed at ending the war.

A screengrab from a handout video shows a Chinese coast guard ship firing a water cannon at a Philippine vessel. REUTERS

The remarks came after protests by both sides this week following a clash bet-

China's Wang Yi warned Manila of "bitter consequences of its own making" if it sought to provoke Beijing with the support of outside powers.

Lovlina assures India's first medal at the Glasgow Games



Judoka Arun Kumar withdrawn from CWG after failing dope test



15-year-old Sooryavanshi becomes youngest to hit T20I half-century



Anahat enters World junior squash quarterfinals; Aryaveer bows out



Rajpal realistic about India's medal chances

Asian Games the bigger goal for Mirabai and coach



Sooryavanshi helps Shreyas' India end winless streak

Dabang Delhi storms into the semifinals

Justice Mittal rebukes AITA interim EC's decision to appoint observer for EGM

CM
Y
K

INBRIEF



Rohit, Venkata shine as India u-19 wins series against SL

Leg-spinner Rohit Yadav and pacer C. Venkata shared seven wickets among them as India u-19 thrashed Sri Lanka u-19 by 211 runs on the fourth day of the second Youth 'Test' in Colombo on Thursday. India won the two-match series 1-0 after the first game ended in a draw. Starting the day at 155 for four, chasing a huge target of 472, the home side folded for 260 in 76.5 overs, shortly into the post-lunch session.

The scores: India u-19 411 & 208/3 decl. bt Sri Lanka u-19 148 & 260 in 76.5 overs (Senuja Wekunagoda 64, Vimath Dinsara 64, C. Venkata 3/27, Rohit Yadav 4/49).

ICC confirms the Oval as venue for 2027 WTC final

The Oval in London has been confirmed as the venue for next year's ICC World Test Championship (WTC) Final, which will be held from June 9 to 13. This will be the second time that the Oval hosts the final, having previously staged the showpiece in 2023.



Ecuador's Carapaz wins Tour de France 18th stage

Ecuador's Richard Carapaz emerged from a six-man group to climb to victory on the Alpine 18th stage of the Tour de France on Thursday. The former Giro d'Italia winner attacked his breakaway companions with just over three kilometres to ride and cruised to his second Tour stage victory, with Swiss Mauro Schmid beating American Matteo Jorgenson to second place.

Sindhu, Ayush, Lakshya bow out of China Open badminton

P.V. Sindhu, Ayush Shetty and Lakshya Sen crashed out of the China Open in the second round in Changzhou on Thursday.

The results (second round): Men: Victor Lai bt Lakshya Sen 21-19, 21-11; Nhat Nguyen bt Ayush Shetty 15-21, 21-13, 22-20. Women: Chen Yufei bt P.V. Sindhu 16-21, 22-20, 21-18.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA women's one-day league, Group-A, Pink Warriors vs Green Invaders (Sumangali-A); Yellow Challengers vs Navy Knights (Wahe Guru-A); Group-B, Orange Dragons vs Purple Blazers (Gojan-A); Red Rangers vs Maroon Mavericks (Gojan-B), 9 a.m.

Uttarakhand's Dhruv and Haryana's Jiya take the honours

BADMINTON

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Uttarakhand's Dhruv Negi beat Rajasthan's Pranay Katta 20-18, 14-16, 15-11 in the final to clinch men's singles title in the Yonex-Sunrise All India senior-ranking badminton tournament at the Jawaharlal Nehru indoor stadium on Thursday.

It was the 20-year-old's maiden senior men's singles title. In the women's final, Haryana's Jiya Rawat defeated Andhra Pradesh's M. Tanishq 15-12, 15-10 to take the honours.

The tournament also threw up a few surprises. Tamil Nadu's mixed doubles specialist K. Sathish Kumar suffered a quarterfinal exit to an unseeded Kerala pair. Reigning Asian u-17 champion S.R. Diksha and Sadhana Fenelon, a bronze medalist at last week's National-ranking



Reigning supreme: Dhruv and Jiya with their big prize.

tournament in Kochi, also bowed out early in the women's singles. The championship was without the National men's singles champion Rithvik Sanjeevi and former junior World No. 1 Sankar Muthusamy as they were away on international duty.

Former Tamil Nadu Cricket Association (TNCA) president Ashok Sigamani and Tamil Nadu Badminton Association (TNBA) se-

cretary Ve. Arunachalam presented the prizes.

Other results (finals): Doubles: Men: Viplav Kuvale & Viraj Kuvale (Mah) bt Mohammad Amaan (Raj) & Dingku Singh Konthoujam (Man) 13-15, 15-4, 15-4.

Women: V.S. Varshini (TN) & Nayana S. Oasis (Ker) bt Rutaparna Panda & Swetaparna Panda (Odi) 15-12, 15-6.

Mixed: Vimalraj Annadurai & Shreya Balaji (TN) bt Sankarprasad Udayakumar & Diya Arun (Ker) 15-8, 15-10.

HOCKEY

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

With the Indian team entering its final stage of preparations for the World Cup, women's hockey coach Sjoerd Marijne is focussing on fitness, aware it could be the difference in a game of small margins.

"That is our main focus now, improving the fitness, because we know they understand the tactics and we have enough matches to practice that. But these are the moments we really have to make the next step in our fitness.

"I think we're doing really well, we are pushing the girls hard. It's always a combination of high intensity and good rest and also finding the quality you want on the pitch. And the better the fitness is, the better the outcome will be," he told The Hindu in an interaction on Thursday.

The team would be leaving for Germany on July 29 to play two matches before



Showing the way: The women's team that won the FIH Nations Cup recently under Marijne.

travelling to Netherlands on August 2. It will play four practice matches against Chile, Japan, Netherlands and Australia before the World Cup starts on August 15 with India's opening game against China.

Two months mater, the team will have a chance to book an Olympic ticket at the Asian Games but Marijne understands the two are very different competitions.

"I think both tournaments are really different, there are different things at stake. Playing Asian teams is completely different than playing European or South American teams.

Chaotic playing style "The playing style at the Asian Games is more chaotic, so we have to stay away from that. I don't see one tournament impacting the other in a negative way. It has been a while since

we played China so we will see what is our level against them.

"I think Netherlands is by far the best team in the world. But, I think they all can win against each other.

"We will always create opportunities and that will be more difficult against higher ranked teams, so if you get three chances, you have to make at least one or two count. We're working really hard on that," he insisted.

'It takes only one game or critical moment to regain confidence'

CHESS

C. Shyam Sundar
CHENNAI

Becoming the World champion is probably easier than being one. This might be running through the mind of D. Gukesh, who is set to defend his title in a few months' time.

The 20-year-old Grandmaster has been going through a prolonged lean spell as the championship clash against Uzbek Javokhir Sindarov looms.

Gukesh hasn't won a tournament since his stunning triumph in Singapore, and the performances have been below-par to say the least. At the just-concluded Chennai Grand Masters here, he lost three games and couldn't buy a win while finishing last in a field of eight. He now has



Gukesh. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

only the Olympiad in September to regain form and be ready to face Sindarov.

Five-time World champion Viswanathan Anand said Gukesh still had time to get out of the rut, ad-

ding: "He must be disappointed with the results, but he will anyway play some more games. He's had a bad streak for a while, but he can snap out of it."

N. Srinath, the captain of the Open team in the upcoming Olympiad, isn't concerned about the form of Gukesh, who was on the top board during the victorious campaign in Budapest two years ago. In this regard, he pointed out that R. Vaishali had a similarly difficult time in the Chennai Grand Masters' Challengers event last year.

"Vaishali won the Grand Swiss title a few months later and then the Candidates. Slumps in form can happen, but class is permanent. It takes only one game, one critical moment to regain confidence," Srinath said, batting for Gukesh.

India has an 'excellent chance' of retaining Olympiad title: Srinath

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

If the India team is to replicate its near-perfect Chess Olympiad 2024 campaign in the Open event, it will take some doing.

India will have the 'defending champion' tag attached to it throughout the global competition in Samarkand in September and will be expected to deliver another strong show.

No baggage

But captain N. Srinath stressed that his squad will not carry any "baggage", saying that it will begin from square one just like any other team.

"We will not do that (put themselves under pressure for being the reigning champ); we are all professionals. We start from zero this time.

"But we will definitely



Indian shooters endure another medal-less day

Press Trust of India
HANGZHOU

Indian shooters endured a second successive medal-less day at the ISSF World Cup (rifle / pistol / shotgun) even as nations like Qatar, Sweden and Norway opened their accounts here on Thursday. Vidarsa Vinod was the lone bright spot, reaching the women's 50m rifle three positions final before finishing sixth. Vidarsa had qualified seventh with a score of 587.

There was some fightback in the men's skeet event Gurjoat Khangura produced two flawless

rounds of 25 to finish qualification with 121/125. He won a shoot-off against Kuwait's Mohammad Alawaad to grab the eighth and last place in the final, eventually finishing sixth.

Abhay Singh Sekhon ended 20th with 119/125.

Among women skeet shooters, Ganemat Sekhon was the best-placed Indian in 23rd with 113/125, followed by Yashasvi Rathore (110) in 28th and Darsha Rathore (109) in 34th.

In men's 25m rapid fire pistol, Bhavesh Shekhawat kept India's hopes alive by ending Stage 1 in ninth place with 292.



Srinath. FILE PHOTO: M. VEDHAN

make up the playing contingent.

"I am pretty confident that we will do excellently. Before the last Olympiad, we never thought that we would win the way we did. We will have the same approach, but we will know about the form of our players only after the first few rounds.

Top challengers

"So, it is hard to say which team will set the standard. Host Uzbekistan, the USA and China will be among the top challengers, but we have an excellent chance," Srinath added. Will his players walk the talk?

The Indian squads: Open: D. Gukesh, R. Praggnanandhaa, Arjun Erigaisi, Vidit Gujrathi and Nihal Sarin; captain: N. Srinath.

Women: Koneru Humpy, R. Vaishali, Divya Deshmukh, Vantika Agrawal and B. Savitha Shri; captain: Swayams Mishra.

AROUND THE CITY

Rohith upsets Oges

Rohith Hari Balaji upset second seed Oges Theyjo in straight sets in the men's singles quarterfinals of the Indium AITA tennis championships at the SDAT stadium on Thursday.

In women's singles, Lakshmi Prabha overcame Deepshika in straight sets to advance to the last four. In the men's wheelchair event, the top six seeds progressed through to the quarterfinals.

In the women's wheelchair league top seed Shilpa had an easy win over her opponents.

The results: Men (quarterfinals): Anura Reddy bt Teertha Shashank 7-6(7), 6-3; Karan Thapa bt S.M. Aadhitiya 4-6, 6-2, 6-4.

Nirav D. Shetty bt Azmeer Shaikh 4-6, 6-4, 6-1. Rohith Hari Balaji bt Oges Theyjo 6-3, 6-4.

Doubles (semifinals): Nirav & Anup Mahadev bt Kandhavel Mahalingam & Kavin Karthik 6-2, 6-2.

Irfan Hussain & Aditya Vardhan Duddupudi bt Srikar Doni & Rohith 7-6(4), 5-7, [10-6]. Women (quarterfinals): Aditi

Rawat bt Joell Nichole 6-2, 6-1; Sahira Singh bt Yubrani Banerjee 7-6(8), 6-2; Lakshmi Prabha bt V. Deepshika 6-3, 6-2; Laxmi Siri Dandu bt Asmi Adkar 6-1, 7-5. Doubles (semifinals): Bela Tamhankar & Asmi Adkar bt Lakshmi Prabha & Sai Samhitha 6-3, 4-6, 10-8. Chevika Reddy & Mirudhula Palanivel bt Saily Prashanth Kumar & Ira Shrenik Shah 7-6(9), 6-3.

TDCA's under-23 selection trials on August 9

The Tiruvallur District Cricket Association will conduct selection trials for the TNCA men's under-23 inter-district one-day tournament on August 9 (7.30 a.m.) at the OCF Cricket Ground, Giri Nagar, Avadi.

Players born on or after September 1, 2003 and residing within the revenue boundaries of Tiruvallur district are eligible. Application forms can be downloaded from tiruvallurdc.a.in.

For further details, contact: 91766 69980, 86681 10757; email: tiruvallurdc.a@gmail.com.



Aswath.

GM Aswath triumphs in Serbia Open

Sports Bureau

Indian Grandmaster Aswath S. emerged champion in the Serbia Open chess tournament in Belgrade, scoring 7.5 points from nine rounds. He remained unbeaten in the event and posted six wins with the one over compatriot Mitrabha Guha in the penultimate round proving to be crucial.

India's Ethan Vaz finished third while Mitrabha took the fourth spot.

LIVE TELECAST

Commonwealth Games: Day 1, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 1.30 p.m.

The satisfaction from scoring runs in Tests is unparalleled

The 24-year-old says even a small weakness or flaw will be challenged in the longest format; the Tamil Nadu batter adds that his priority now is to work on his fitness and game against spin bowling ahead of the Sri Lanka series; the southpaw explains he is not worried too much about not being in the T20I scheme of things

INTERVIEW

B. Sai Sudharsan

S. Dipak Ragav

Since the start of the IPL, runs have been flowing from B. Sai Sudharsan's bat. The Gujarat Titans opener had a great season, finishing as the third-highest run-getter (722 runs). He then seamlessly switched into the longer format, scoring 81 in the Test against Afghanistan before following it up with twin centuries for India-A in the two four-day games in Sri Lanka.

In this chat with *The Hindu*, the 24-year-old Tamil Nadu batter opens up about his "best IPL season" as well as his experience playing Test cricket over the last year. Excerpts:

How do you see this purple patch?

I am feeling really grateful for whatever I have done in the IPL. The way it started, the way it unfolded, the way it ended – it was very interesting.

I have always had good starts in every IPL. So this one was even more interesting because I didn't score much in the first four to five games. Mentally, I won't say it was challenging but more interesting, as belief, trust, and everything increased day by day rather than becoming doubtful. It was a very good IPL, and it was my best year.

Does it make it more special that you recovered from a tough start?

Yes, for sure, because when you are scoring, it is easy. When you keep playing, it is easier to believe and to be in a confident frame of mind. But when you don't score, it's even more important to feel the same way.

So, in that way, it was very interesting, and I learnt a lot in this IPL. When it is not converted into evidence, are you still trusting the process and your abilities? Mentally, when you enter the game, are you still thinking about not scoring in the previous match, or are you entering in an expressive frame of mind to make an impact for the team? So I think, in those ways, I learnt a lot – to not take the past into the game.

Was there a specific game that unlocked something for you?

Yes. I got a hundred against RCB. That was the game which actually changed quite a lot of things. We lost that match, yes, but that game gave us momentum. From there, the team also did well. The team faced a challenge: we were still doing well, but something was not going right. Then we won in Chennai, and from there, everybody's game started going the way we wanted.

You came into the IPL after an injury lay-off due to a rib fracture. How difficult was the recovery?

Definitely, it was not easy because breathing was difficult. But sometimes, when you get a break, you have time to think about the game. You have time to really introspect about what you want to do. So I saw it as a blessing in disguise. At that time, I wanted to use it wisely and productively, so that I would still bat a lot mentally. I couldn't do it physically, of course, but mentally I batted a lot and didn't feel that I was away from the sport.

What did you specifically work on during those three to four months?

It's more about the feel. The feeling of batting. All the small things I wanted to improve, all the small additions I wanted to make – I just did them in my head. I tried to visualise it more and sustain that feeling.

There's a lot of talk around strike-rates. However, you and your opening partner, Shubman Gill, took a different approach, trying to bat long. How do you see it in the bigger picture when the demands of T20 cricket keep changing? Do you feel tempted to play at a higher tempo?

We're not looking at it as 'We have to play at this strike-rate to win'. We're looking at it from a broad-



er perspective – what is required for the game, rather than individual statistical points. We're not looking at it as a stats-oriented approach. Yes, stats are very important for improving and getting better. But we're not looking to predetermine how we'll play. If we're chasing 240, we have to play at a 200 strike-rate anyway. It's situational, rather than saying we can only do well if we play at a particular strike-rate. As a team, as you rightly said, we're trying to give ourselves the best chance of winning.

At the same time, don't you feel it could affect your personal career?

It's actually a great question because it's actually a challenge as well. But I feel winning is the ultimate recipe, or the ultimate key, to whatever you want to do. You don't have to think personally. For a team, winning is the ultimate recipe. If you make your team win, you will eventually get the call-up and recognition. Everything else is secondary. It is a by-product. The ultimate goal is to have the team's intent to win. The way I'm looking at it is: Am I giving myself the best possible chance to contribute? I feel that if we put a constraint like that in place, we are holding ourselves back.

You have now scored more than 700 runs for the second consecutive season. How do you ensure you keep improving to stay ahead in a format that keeps changing?

Even during the tournament, the game is evolving. This year, there were two spectrums of games. Either they were very low-scoring or very high-scoring. At the start of the tournament, there were three or four situations in which it was still possible to hit the ball correctly. I learnt certain things from that. I got out to balls that weren't really wicket-taking deliveries. They were short, into the body, down the side of the leg. So I felt there was still space for the right movements to happen, and then you score runs. I worked more on that.

Similarly, there were many examples from last year and this year. At certain times, I wasn't finishing games, so I wanted to finish games. I feel I'm aware of those things. I keep building on them so the batting works automatically.

How do you handle not being in India's T20 plans despite two very good IPL seasons?

There is nothing to handle. No disappointment, no expectation. We have a job in our hands. As simple as that. I know it may sound contradictory to many people. Yes, everybody wants to play for the country, and I want it even more. But what's important is understanding what is within our control and what we should be hungry for. In the IPL, the important job is to put the team where we want it to be and win the tournament.

That's the biggest priority. Selection comes as a by-product. There are still many things I can improve. I can work on those, come back to the IPL, and make an even bigger impact. Those are the things I have in my control, and I will back myself to do that every year.

Your assessment of your first year as a Test cricketer?

It is interesting. Even a small weakness or flaw will be challenged. As a batter, you have to keep improving and evolving from all those small things. It changes every single day and every single session. To be versatile enough to understand that and be smart is very important. But the satisfaction you get from scoring runs in Tests is unparalleled. You toil for five days. The hard work on the fourth or fifth day, when you get those runs or that win, is just very satisfying.

What have been the biggest learnings from the first year?

We have to keep evolving as batters, and there isn't much time to do so. You have to be smart enough to pick things up and evolve. I feel it is all about owning that place. I could have owned it a bit more. I could have been a bit freer. The more ownership I take, and the

more courage I have to go out there and express myself, the more I feel I'll be able to bring out the best version of myself. That's probably the biggest learning for me.

A little bit of that happened during the Afghanistan series. It helped me express myself more rather than trying to be right.

But hats off to my team: because of the support staff, the communication, and the way they supported and backed me – I was very happy with that.

Even in the Kolkata Test (vs. South Africa), which I didn't play, I was very comfortable because the communication was very clear. We were looking at an extra spinner to give us the best chance. The communication was very clear, and as a player, you need that freedom.

During the West Indies series, GG (Gautam Gambhir) sir was very communicative. He backed me really well. In the Delhi Test (vs. West Indies), I was actually happy because I understood my batting better. I needed that clarity at that time, so it was very helpful to me.

I feel my batting has also become a little more fine-tuned. Decision-making, footwork, and movement in the crease–these experiences have helped me further fine-tune my game.

After the South Africa tour, I had quite a lot of time to prepare, understand those things and fine-tune them.

You have been dismissed twice in the 80s. Do you regret not converting those starts?

I'd agree that it was a little disappointing not to convert them. But at the same time, I was really happy with the level of control I had and the intensity of my play. The feeling while batting was really good, and the control was good. So I'm looking forward to building on that. The big score will come when it's supposed to come.

There has been some criticism surrounding your First Class average. Are you aware of that, and how do you handle it?

Honestly, I'm not even aware of my own statistics. I don't know how many matches I've played, how many hundreds I've scored or what my average is. Even in the IPL, I don't know how many games I've played or how many runs I've scored. The reason is simple – I don't want to judge myself based on statistics. I believe more in the experience than the numbers. One game might be on a

raging turner. Another game could be on a seaming wicket.

Every match presents a different challenge. So it's very difficult for me to look at my average and tell myself, 'I'm batting well because my average is good' or, 'I'm batting badly because my average isn't good enough'. For me, it's about being fully present in that particular situation and doing the best I possibly can.

How was your experience of playing those two four-day games in Sri Lanka?

It was a really valuable experience and a great opportunity for us to understand the conditions. There was more breeze, a little more bounce and a little more turn than what we're generally used to. Even the bowling culture there is different.

The bowlers are extremely consistent and disciplined rather than relying on something extraordinary. As a batter, getting more game time in Test cricket is always the best opportunity to learn.

Luckily, we played at Galle, so we got an opportunity to understand how the wickets behaved and how they generally prepared the surfaces.

Overall, it was a really good experience and a great opportunity for us to understand the conditions.

Can you elaborate on the impact of the breeze?

The strong breeze changes everything. Because of the wind, the ball's line changes quite a lot. Experiencing that was really valuable. It's actually very similar to England.

In England, the fast bowlers get late movement. Here, because of the breeze, the spinners get late drift. So you can't commit too early, and you can't judge the length too early. You have to keep judging the ball as late as possible because it keeps changing its line.

What's the next month looking like for you?

The next month will be a proper off-season with some long practice sessions. Overall, it's a great window to work hard and build towards the coming season.

There are two main areas. The first is from a physical perspective. I want to become stronger, leaner, and fitter, especially in my movement and recovery, so that I can recover better and faster.

The second is my batting. I want to continue fine-tuning my game against spin.

We have a series against Sri Lanka, where the conditions are quite similar, and then a couple of Tests in New Zealand, which will obviously present a different challenge. So my focus is on improving my batting against spin, better understanding my footwork, and continuing to develop my game.



R. RAGU

HEALTH

Building resilience to protect elderly from climate stressors

There are many other factors including financial capacity, living alone, gender, age that intersect to render senior citizens particularly vulnerable during extreme climate events and slow-onset climate hazards; a recent study calls for a points to a layered response to grow resilience both at the household and community level

Ramya Kannan

In its sweep, climate change is not an equitable overlord, and while it does create havoc, it is true that this impacts some people more than others. There are, now, studies to show that vulnerable groups of people are affected far more than others and the factors that determine how badly you are affected include economic ability, age and gender. A recent study by HelpAge India further highlights the fact that senior citizens form a vulnerable group and are right in the pathway of harm left in the trail of climate change.

There are two ways in which climate change affects older adults – sudden shocks and slow-onset stresses. The report says rising temperatures, erratic rainfall, drought, flooding, coastal erosion, water scarcity, poor ventilation, indoor heat stress, dampness, and environmental degradation can worsen chronic illness, raise mortality risk, reduce mobility, and increase care needs for senior citizens.

For them it could manifest as a number of things – heat-related stress, respiratory problems, reduced mobility, mental distress, sleep disruption, and disruption in access to medicines and healthcare during climatic events.

In addition changing socio-cultural norms and migration patterns indicate that older people can become isolated, leading to an impact on their mental health as well. As the country learns to become more heat resilient, it should also focus on protecting older people’s health, dignity, mobility, income, housing and social support structures, without which they will be rendered further vulnerable.

This is particularly relevant to India, where the portion of senior citizens as a part of the overall population is constantly growing. As the nation is steadily moving towards the greys, the older population is projected to rise to about 347 million by 2050 (from 149 million in 2022). Naturally climate stress will make a larger share of the country vulnerable to physical and mental health challenges.

Several factors

The report identifies several factors that sharply reduce resilience: living alone, poor physical or mental health, impairment, advanced age, poverty, financial dependence, weak institutional support, insecure housing, and residence in hazard-prone locations. These disadvantages often overlap, which is why the study uses an “Intersectional Place Perspective” to show that risk is shaped by the interaction of age, gender, widowhood, disability, poverty, social isolation, and local environmental conditions. For example, an uneducated, unskilled older widow with no pension, was at a relatively greater risk from a



Shades of grey: The population of elderly persons is projected to rise from 149 million in 2022 to about 347 million by 2050 in the country. Naturally climate stress will make a larger share of the country vulnerable to physical and mental health challenges. T. APPALA NAIDU

cyclone, that an able-bodied older man who lived with his family.

Anupama Datta, Head, Policy Research & Advocacy, HelpAge India, who led this research study, said the focus was on districts impacted by slow onset climate hazards. “Older persons bring unique strengths as well as vulnerabilities that shape how they experience and respond to climate hazards. Repeated episodes of climate hazards weaken their ability to recover and build resilience.

Caring for elderly

There are a number of environmental stressors that will impact the life of the elderly, says Soumya Swaminathan, chairperson, M.S.Swaminathan Research Foundation, Chennai. The institution has launched a two-State study to evaluate the impact of increase in temperature on the health of the residents.

What can be urgently done here, she says, is to establish special care facilities for the elderly, such as those in Thailand, where a community space is created for elders, in both rural and urban areas, where they can come together, engage in activities and receive comprehensive primary health care as well. Handling the loneliness and bringing the community around the senior citizens will have an impact on mitigating their vulnerabilities. “We must first think of establishing this basic level of care for the elders and then address issues like heat with particular reference to the elderly,” she says, adding that a fresh vulnerability that is emerging through studies indicates that heat could also be a stressor to accelerate ageing itself.

The Helpage report points to a layered

response to grow resilience: at the household level, storing food and water, improving shelter, saving money, planning ahead for disasters, and diversifying livelihoods. However useful they are, they may not be enough for persons with multiple disadvantages. At the community level, family support, neighbour check-ins, volunteer networks, and community shelter or relocation support are recommended coping strategies. It also recommends age-inclusive early warning systems, community monitoring, and stronger local care networks, especially for those living alone or with impairments.

In terms of policy recommendations, it calls for climate-resilient healthcare for elders, expanded social protection and livelihood support, and targeted support for the groups at highest risk of being affected.

The strongest policy priorities in the document are: climate-resilient healthcare for older persons, expanded social protection and livelihood support, better disaster preparedness and early warning systems, climate-resilient housing, environmental health interventions, and stronger community-based care networks. It also calls for targeted support for the highest-risk groups: those living alone, widows, persons with impairments, the oldest-old, and financially insecure households.

Ms. Datta explains that while government schemes serve as lifeline for older persons, and provide a critical safety net, they follow general rules. The schemes are not currently designed keeping in mind the vulnerabilities of the

older persons, especially those who are uneducated, physically weak or impaired, oldest old, living alone. She explains that “access is particularly challenging for older persons with poor health (30%), those severely affected by climate-related shocks (30%), with no formal education (22%), and from lower socio-economic groups (22%). Additional challenges include, long waiting times and delays (25%), digital access difficulties (15%), and lack of support during the application process (10%), highlighting the need for more age-friendly service delivery.”

Examples of interventions

The report also highlights certain examples of interventions that worked, in order that they might be scaled up or adapted for implementation in other contexts. In Odisha, it says, older persons received early warnings for storms and cyclones from the village panchayat and were evacuated to safe community shelters in time. It also points to organised grass roots volunteerism where organisations or a band of individuals co-ordinate with the official systems to organise relief, evacuations and post-facto care during disasters.

For India, the report’s conclusions are very clear: shift from ‘hazard-centred’ responses to ‘people-centred’ systems to connect climate adaptation, healthy ageing, social protection, and disaster risk reduction. That involves harnessing One Health, generating and using better data, establishing stronger institutional coordination, and services that are designed by factoring in older persons’ actual barriers to access.

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THE GIST

A recent study by HelpAge India further highlights the fact that senior citizens form a vulnerable group and are right in the pathway of harm left in the trail of climate change. This is particularly relevant to India, where the portion of senior citizens as a part of the overall population is constantly growing

The report identifies several factors that sharply reduce resilience: living alone, poor physical or mental health, impairment, advanced age, poverty, financial dependence, weak institutional support, insecure housing, and residence in hazard-prone locations. These disadvantages often overlap, which is why the study uses an “Intersectional Place Perspective” to show that risk is shaped by the interaction of age, gender, widowhood, disability, poverty, social isolation, and local environmental conditions

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BIG SHOT



Medical supplies donated by India arriving in Kenya, which has stepped up Ebola surveillance following an outbreak in the neighbouring Democratic Republic of Congo. REUTERS

Can time outdoors become part of healthcare?

Athira Elssa Johnson

Healthcare systems in several countries are exploring whether structured time in natural environments can complement conventional care amid rising rates of stress, anxiety and chronic disease.

Green prescriptions, blue prescriptions and other forms of nature-based social prescribing involve healthcare professionals recommending activities in parks, gardens or near water bodies alongside standard treatment.

The premise is not that nature replaces medicine, but that spending time in natural settings may support mental well-being, encourage physical activity and promote social interaction. While research suggests mental health benefits, evidence for long-term physical health outcomes remains limited. Experts also stress that the effectiveness of these interventions depends on urban planning, environmental protection and equitable access to safe public spaces.

Green and blue prescriptions are forms of nature-based social prescribing. Green prescriptions encourage activities in parks, gardens or other green spaces, while blue prescriptions involve



Time spent in forests and gardens is increasingly being seen as an addition to medication-based care. PTI

spending time near rivers, lakes, wetlands or the coast.

Forest bathing, or *shinrin-yoku*, originated in Japan in the 1980s. Unlike exercise-focused activities, it involves spending quiet time in a forest while engaging with the surrounding environment. “Forest bathing is less about physical activity and more about being fully present in a natural environment,” says Vinod Prem Anand, senior consultant in internal medicine at MGM Healthcare, Chennai. “Green and blue prescriptions, meanwhile, are recommendations made by healthcare professionals as part of

nature-based social prescribing.”

Other approaches include horticultural therapy and care farming, typically delivered in more structured settings.

Research suggests nature-based interventions may reduce stress, anxiety and depressive symptoms while improving mood and psychological well-being. Some studies have also reported modest improvements in blood pressure, sleep quality and stress-related physiological markers.

Good evidence

“There is reasonably good evidence for reduced anxiety, lower depressive symptoms and improved mood, particularly among people experiencing stress-related conditions,” says Nithya M., consultant psychiatrist, Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Vanagaram. Evidence also points to improved attention and reduced cognitive fatigue, although it remains unclear how much exposure is needed or how long benefits persist.

Dr. Vinod cites a systematic review in the *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health* that found associations between nature-based social prescribing and improved mental and physical health outcomes. The

United Kingdom’s National Health Service has incorporated green and blue prescribing into parts of its social prescribing programme.

However, experts caution against overstating the evidence. “Many available studies involve relatively small numbers of participants,” says R. Sundararaman, senior consultant in internal medicine at SIMS Hospital, Chennai. “The findings are encouraging, but larger, well-designed studies are still needed.”

Researchers believe several factors contribute to the observed benefits. Nature-based activities often combine physical activity, social interaction and a break from stressful environments. Morning daylight may also support healthy sleep-wake cycles.

Doctors stress these interventions complement rather than replace evidence-based care.

“The biggest misconception is that these approaches can replace conventional therapy. They cannot,” says Dr. Nithya.

Experts say wider adoption in India will also depend on multiple factors as rapid urbanisation, air pollution, traffic, safety concerns and unequal access to green spaces already limit opportunities. (athira.elsa@thehindu.co.in)

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Death toll in Sikkim hydropower tunnel disaster

25 The death toll in the Sikkim hydropower tunnel disaster has risen to 25 after authorities recovered the bodies of the remaining trapped workers, bringing the four-day rescue operation to an end. Officials said a methane gas explosion triggered the tunnel collapse. AP

Amount sanctioned by Punjab govt. for various schemes

2,150 in ₹ crore. The Punjab government has released over ₹2,150 crore under various social security schemes during the current financial year up to June, Women and Child Development Minister Baljit Kaur said on Thursday. PTI

Estimated cost of Phase-II strategic oil reserves to be built

14,527 in ₹ crore. India plans to develop the second phase of its strategic petroleum reserve programme under a public-private partnership (PPP) model, with government viability gap funding capped at 60% of the total project cost, the government said. PTI

Number of road accident deaths in India in 2025

1.83 lakh. A total of 1.83 lakh people lost their lives in road accidents in India in 2025, when 5.13 lakh road accidents were reported across the country, Parliament was informed. On average, 59 road accidents took place every hour, resulting in 21 deaths every hour. PTI

Amount sanctioned by Kerala govt. for social security pensions

1,095 in ₹ crore. The Kerala government has sanctioned over ₹1,095 crore for the distribution of social security and welfare board pensions for July, benefiting more than 65 lakh people across the State. PTI
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How should cities reclaim footpaths?

Why was the Street Vendors Act enacted? What does the Act require before vendors can be removed? What is the role of the Town Vending Committee? Can street vendors be evicted before a survey is completed? Why has Bengaluru's footpath drive come under scrutiny?

EXPLAINER

Rishita Khanna

The story so far:

Following the Supreme Court's recognition of the right to walk on safe, obstruction-free footpaths as a fundamental right, Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda directed the five city corporations under the Greater Bengaluru Authority to launch a 10-day 'Safe Footpath' drive. The drive removed thousands of street vendors from pavements and cleared encroachments. While many welcomed the initiative, it also raised questions over whether the removals complied with the Street Vendors (Protection of Livelihood and Regulation of Street Vending) Act, 2014, which seeks to balance pedestrians' right to walk with street vendors' right to livelihood.

Why was the Street Vendors Act enacted?

The Supreme Court's recognition of the right to walk does not mean street vending has no place on public streets. Long before the latest ruling, the court had repeatedly held that street vending is a 'legitimate' occupation protected under Article 19 of the Constitution, while making it clear that it can be regulated in the public interest.

Those judgments were born out of a recurring pattern – municipal bodies and police evicting vendors, mostly without notice, reducing years of livelihoods to rubble overnight.

The Street Vendors (Protection of Livelihood and Regulation of Street Vending) Act, 2014, was enacted to end such arbitrary removals by laying down the process for regulating street vending.

Contrary to popular perception, the Act is neither an anti-encroachment law nor one that gives vendors an unrestricted right over public spaces.



In Bengaluru, corporations started removing vendors before putting in place the mechanism through which the Act is meant to work. K. MURALI KUMAR

Instead, it seeks to balance two competing rights – the public's right to safe, obstruction-free footpaths and a street vendor's right to earn a livelihood. It lays down a step-by-step process that every city is expected to follow before deciding who can vend, where they can vend and when they can be removed or relocated.

What process does the Act prescribe before vendors can be removed?

The first step is the constitution of a Town Vending Committee (TVC), the backbone of the law.

The committee includes officials, police, planning authorities, resident representatives and street vendors themselves, who must make up at least 40% of its members, with representation for women and other marginalised communities. The idea is that decisions affecting vendors should not be taken without vendors having a seat at the table. Every subsequent step is expected to flow

through this committee.

Once the committee is constituted, the Act requires it to survey all street vendors. The survey is meant to identify existing vendors before the authorities decide who can continue vending and under what conditions.

Moreover, the Act protects existing vendors during this process. It states that no street vendor should be evicted or relocated until the survey has been completed and Certificates of Vending have been issued. The protection was built into the law to prevent exactly the kind of arbitrary removals that had prompted its enactment.

Once the survey is completed, eligible vendors are issued a Certificate of Vending. It is official permission to vend at a specified location and under specified conditions. The certificate does not give a vendor ownership over public land. It only recognises the right to vend in accordance with the Act.

The Act does not prohibit the removal

of street vendors. It only requires that such action follow the process laid down under the law.

Why has Bengaluru's footpath drive come under scrutiny?

In Bengaluru, corporations started removing vendors before putting in place the mechanism through which the Act is meant to work.

Although Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar later promised relocation, the Act requires a TVC to identify vending and no-vending zones. Bengaluru does not have one.

While the Karnataka government acted on the Supreme Court's recognition of pedestrians' right to safe footpaths, the Street Vendors Act makes it equally clear that reclaiming those footpaths cannot become a justification for bypassing the safeguards enacted to protect street vendors' livelihoods. That balance, not the primacy of one right over the other, is the very foundation of the law.

THE GIST

The Street Vendors Act, 2014, was enacted to regulate street vending by balancing pedestrians' right to safe, obstruction-free footpaths with street vendors' right to livelihood, while preventing arbitrary evictions.

The Act requires authorities to constitute a Town Vending Committee, conduct surveys, issue Certificates of Vending and identify vending and no-vending zones before vendors are removed or relocated.

The right to protest and the limits of police power

What the Constitution, the BNSS and court rulings say about regulating demonstrations and the use of force

Devyanshi Bihani

The story so far:

People from across the country gathered at Jantar Mantar in central Delhi on July 20 for the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) "Chalo Sansad" march, carrying placards demanding reforms in the National Testing Agency (NTA) and the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Within hours, the demonstration descended into clashes. Police used tear gas and *lathi* charges to disperse protesters attempting to march towards Parliament. Tear gas enveloped parts of the protest route as demonstrators ran to escape the crackdown. Several nearby Metro stations were temporarily closed, and many demonstrators reported losing mobile connectivity during the march, making communication and coordination difficult.

The incident has again brought an old question into focus: how should a democracy police public protest?

Is the right to protest absolute?

The Constitution guarantees citizens the right to assemble peacefully under Article 19(1)(b). But that right is subject to "reasonable restrictions" under Article 19(3) in the interests of public order, the sovereignty and integrity of India, and other constitutionally recognised grounds. In practice, these restrictions are implemented through laws governing public order and policing.

The legal authority to regulate protests, however, comes from a range of statutes.

Was the CJP march unlawful?

Whether a protest is "unlawful" is a legal question that depends on the facts and circumstances of each case. Under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), an assembly of five or more persons becomes an unlawful assembly only if its common object falls within specific categories, such as using criminal force, resisting the execution of law, committing an offence, or compelling another person by force or threat. A gathering that begins lawfully may also become unlawful if its

conduct changes over the course of the event.

Ahead of the march, Delhi Police said the CJP had not sought permission for a procession to Parliament. It also pointed to prohibitory orders issued under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which barred protests, marches and demonstrations in the New Delhi district, except at the designated Jantar Mantar protest site with prior permission. As demonstrators attempted to march towards Parliament, officers stopped the procession and eventually used tear gas and *lathi* charges to disperse the crowd. The authorities' response has since come under judicial scrutiny, with the Delhi High Court seeking responses from the Centre and the Delhi Police on petitions alleging police brutality and excessive use of force.

What standards govern police action?

The National Human Rights Commission's Manual on Human Rights for Police Officers emphasises that effective policing and respect for human rights are

complementary rather than conflicting objectives.

It states that "A democratic country like India needs democratic policing, which is based on the idea of the police as protectors of the rights of citizens and the rule of law, while ensuring the safety and security of all equally." The manual also notes that human rights violations by police can have "a multi-dimensional impact" by eroding public confidence, bringing institutions into disrepute and "even escalating civil unrest at times."

The principles are consistent with the UN Basic Principles on the Use of Force and Firearms, which require force to be lawful, necessary and proportionate.

When can police use force?

Under the BNSS, an Executive Magistrate or an authorised police officer may order an unlawful assembly, or an assembly likely to disturb public peace, to disperse. If the assembly does not comply, the law permits it to be dispersed by force.

The Code of Conduct for the Police in India states that police should, as far as practicable, "use the methods of persuasion, advice and warning. When the application of force becomes inevitable, only the irreducible minimum force required in the circumstances should be used." Beyond the use of force itself, the protests also raised questions about police accountability after videos appeared to show some police personnel without visible name tags or with their faces covered. While the BNSS requires every police officer arresting to bear an

accurate, visible and clear identification of his or her name, it contains no corresponding requirement for police personnel engaged in crowd-control or the dispersal of assemblies.

How has the Supreme Court viewed protests?

A day after the clashes, a lawyer urged the Supreme Court to take *suo motu* cognisance of the alleged police excesses, citing videos circulating online. Chief Justice of India Surya Kant orally declined the request, saying, "We are not interested in videos... Don't waste our [court's] time, and don't waste your time."

Over the years, however, the Supreme Court has repeatedly laid down principles governing both the right to protest and the limits of police action.

In *Anita Thakur v. State of Jammu & Kashmir* (2016), the court held that the use of excessive force violates fundamental rights and awarded compensation to the injured protesters, emphasising that police action must remain reasonable and accountable.

More recently, in *Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India* (2018), the court reiterated that while authorities may regulate demonstrations to maintain public order, they cannot extinguish the right to protest altogether. In *Amit Sahni v. Commissioner of Police* (2020), arising from the Shaheen Bagh protests, it affirmed that dissent is a constitutional right but cannot result in the indefinite occupation of public spaces.

